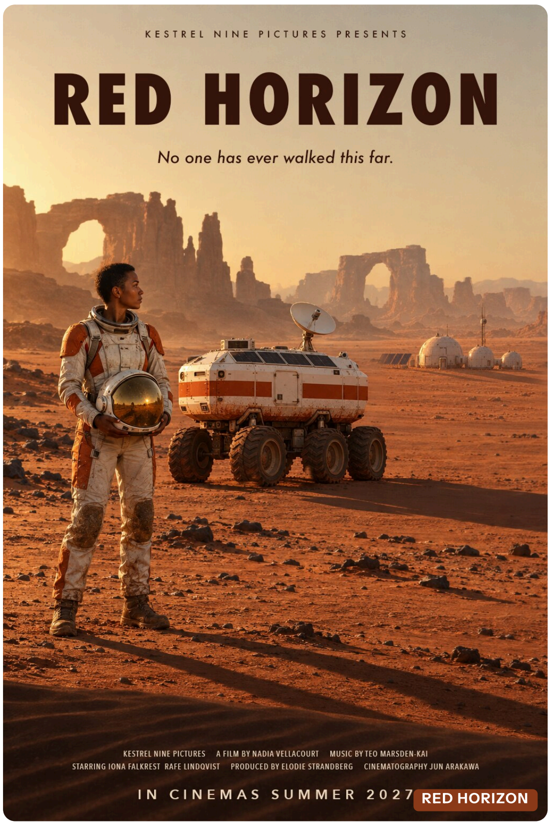
scenario

GUIDE · V3 · 2026-10-28

Scenario for Photoshop, *two posters from start to finish.*

Red Horizon from an empty document to the poster, then its formats, print, motion and agents, with The Last Keeper where it shows a step of its own.


KESTREL NINE PICTURES PRESENTS
RED HORIZON
No one has ever walked this far.
KESTREL NINE PICTURES   A FILM BY NADIA VELLACOURT   MUSIC BY TEO MARSDEN-KAI
STARRING IONA FALKREST RAFE LINDQVIST   PRODUCED BY ELODIE STRANDBERG   CINEMATOGRAPHY JUN ARAKAWA
IN CINEMAS SUMMER 2027
RED HORIZON

Scenario for Photoshop is a panel that brings Scenario's image, edit, upscale, layer and video models into Photoshop. It reads what you are working on, a selection, a layer, a cut-out, a set of takes or a blank canvas, offers the actions that fit, shows the price on the button and lands every result as layers in one History state.

This guide follows two posters made in Photoshop with the panel. **RED HORIZON**, a photoreal science-fiction poster, runs through every chapter. **THE LAST KEEPER**, a gouache poster, comes in where it shows a step that Red Horizon did not run, or shows it better. Each chapter pairs a Photoshop tool with a Scenario action, in the order of the launch film.

04 Create
File › New, then Create image

05 Select
Select › Modify and the Lasso, then Replace inside

06 Character
Lasso, Marquee and Type, then Cut out, Make versions, New layer

07 Layers
Split into layers, then a layer mask and Hue/Saturation

08 Formats
The Type tool, then Formats, then Move

09 Print
Stamp Visible, then Upscale

10 Motion
The Timeline, then Animate

11 Agents
Photoshop's History, then the Scenario MCP

01 The idea
02 Install and sign in
03 The panel
12 Versions, takes, models
13 Prices and Jobs
14 Library and Settings
15 Privacy and files
16 Troubleshooting
17 Known limits

The finished poster of Red Horizon. Covers the development build 0.7.1 (October 2026) on Photoshop 2026 (27.1.1, macOS). Every picture is a real run in Photoshop, pressed through the development build's own driver, and carries the name of its example; prices are those the panel showed. The project name is blurred in every panel picture. Claims carry how they were checked: **VERIFIED LIVE** in Photoshop, **TESTED AUTOMATED** by the test suite, or **NOT TESTED**. Code, issues and the full docs: github.com/scenario-labs/photoshop-plugin.

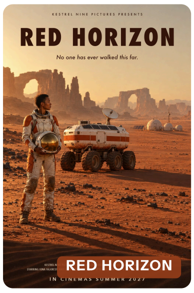
01 · THE IDEA

Photoshop's own tools, *plus Scenario's models.*

The panel does not replace Photoshop. You keep drawing selections, stacking layers, setting type and masking adjustments. Scenario adds what those tools cannot do alone: draw a new element into a selection, draw a figure from another side, rebuild a flat picture as layers, reframe for every format, double the pixels, animate. Each result lands as Photoshop expects it, a masked layer, a group of takes or a new document, so the next Photoshop tool works on it at once.

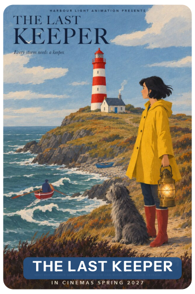
Chapter	In Photoshop	With Scenario	What you get
04 Create	File › New, 1024 × 1536	Create image, four takes	The key art as a group of takes on your canvas
05 Select	Select › Modify › Expand and Feather; the Lasso	Select by description; Replace inside, Bolder or Inside selection	The rover repainted, an outpost on the empty plain, a boat on the sea, each on its own masked layer
06 Character	Lasso, Rectangular Marquee, Type tool	Cut out subject, Make versions, Remove background, New layer	A character sheet: front, three-quarter, side and back, her helmet, live labels
07 Layers	Layer mask, Free Transform, Hue/Saturation	Split into layers, Select by description	The picture as editable layers, recoloured with one adjustment
08 Formats	Type tool for the poster's lines; Move	Formats	Story, Feed, Square and Wide artboards, each with its live type
09 Print	Stamp Visible; Image › Image Size	Upscale ×2	A 2048 × 3072 document, 17.3 × 26 cm at 300 ppi
10 Motion	The Timeline	Animate	A five-second clip as a video document
11 Agents	History, one step per change	The Scenario MCP for Claude Code, Codex, Cursor	An agent that works in your document, with every spend approved in the panel

Two examples


KESTREL NINE PICTURES PRESENTS
RED HORIZON
No one has ever walked this far.
RED HORIZON
IN CINEMAS SUMMER 2027

Red Horizon

A photoreal science-fiction poster: an explorer on Mars holding her helmet, her six-wheeled rover and a research outpost on the plain. It runs through every chapter.



The Last Keeper

A gouache poster: a lighthouse keeper in a yellow raincoat, her shaggy dog, the lighthouse and a rowing boat on the sea. It shows Inside selection, the Model menu with its prices, and Hue/Saturation layers clipped to split elements.

Three rules hold for every action

The price is on the button

Checked for free about half a second after each change, and shown on the button before you click: Create image · 47 CU.

Your click is the approval

Nothing is captured, uploaded or spent before you click. Large prices and price ranges ask once more on a card.

One History state

Each result lands in one step you can undo, and each layer keeps its Scenario metadata: model, prompt, settings, price.

Buttons in this guide follow the panel: the action button is a blue rounded rectangle with its price, Replace inside · 23 CU; chips and other buttons are pills, Make versions. Each picture carries the name of its example, RED HORIZON or THE LAST KEEPER; steps that neither example ran are described in text, without a picture.

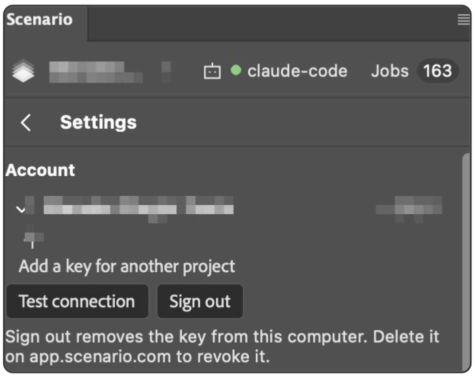
02 · INSTALL AND SIGN IN

Build once, *sign in with a Project key.*

Photoshop 2026 (27.x)
macOS (tested), Windows (built, not tested)
Node.js 20 or later to build
Scenario plan with API access (Starter or above)
Project key with the Editor role

> **Development build.** The plugin is not on the Adobe Marketplace yet. You build the `.ccx` package from the repository and install it with Creative Cloud's installer. The development package installs this way VERIFIED LIVE; the release package's install and the time to a first image are NOT TESTED.

1. From a checkout of `github.com/scenario-labs/photoshop-plugin`, run `npm ci`, then `npm run package`. It writes `build/scenario-photoshop-0.7.1.ccx`.
2. Install the package with Creative Cloud's Unified Plugin Installer Agent (`--install` and the path to the `.ccx`, command in the README), then restart Photoshop. Double-clicking the `.ccx` should do the same NOT TESTED.
3. Open **Plugins › Scenario**. The panel opens on **Connect your Scenario account**.
4. On app.scenario.com, in the project you want to use, create a **Project key** with the **Editor** role and copy the key and its secret. Only team admins and project owners can create keys: **Copy a request for your admin** prepares the message.
5. Paste both and click **Save and test**. Pasting `key:secret`, or the two on two lines, fills both fields. The plugin checks the key with two free reads.
6. Make a document with **File › New**: Photoshop hides docked panels on its Home screen, so the panel shows once a document is open.



Sign out removes the key from this computer. Delete it on app.scenario.com to revoke it.

RED HORIZON Settings › Account during the shoot. The project name and the key are blurred here.

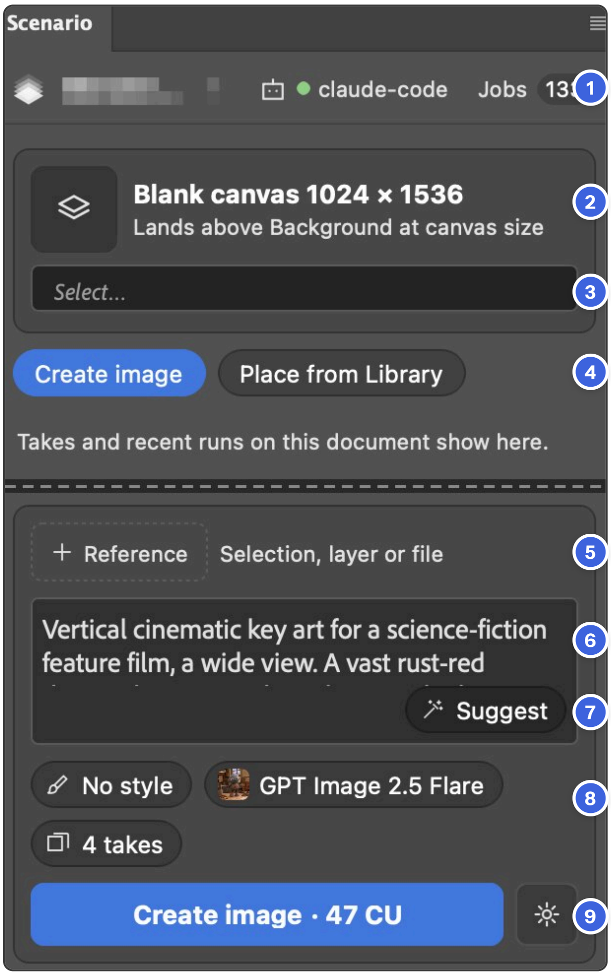
Where the key is kept	Photoshop's secure storage for this plugin, one entry per project, encrypted under your operating system account. It goes only to Scenario's API over HTTPS, never to the helper or to agents.
Another project	**Add a key for another project**, then click the project name in the panel header to switch.
Test connection	Checks the saved key again.
Sign out	Removes the key from this computer only. Delete the key on app.scenario.com to revoke it.
A spending cap	A limit on the key, set on app.scenario.com, caps what the plugin and connected agents can spend.

Signing in was checked live through the development build's key import; typing or pasting into the fields, and the screens for a refused key or a plan without API access, are NOT TESTED live (chapter 16 lists their messages).

03 · THE PANEL

One panel beside your layers, *read from top to bottom.*

Scenario is a docked Photoshop panel. It resizes with its column and keeps one order: header, context card, action chips, Takes and Recent, and the composer pinned at the bottom. Here it is on the first frame of Red Horizon, a blank canvas with the prompt typed.



Blank canvas 1024 × 1536
Lands above Background at canvas size

Takes and recent runs on this document show here.

Vertical cinematic key art for a science-fiction feature film, a wide view. A vast rust-red

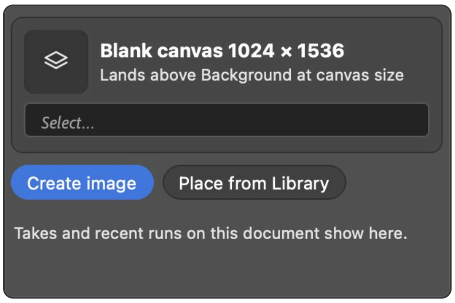
RED HORIZON The panel on the blank canvas. The dashed line stands for the empty middle of the panel.

1. **Header:** the signed-in project (click to switch; blurred here), the agent icon with its dot (chapter 11), and **Jobs** with a count (chapter 13).
2. **Context card:** what the panel works on and where the result lands, here "Blank canvas 1024 × 1536". During a run it shows the progress: "Generating 4 takes".
3. **Select…:** Select by description (chapter 05).
4. **Action chips:** the actions for this context, at most six, then More for the others, in groups. A pin in More adds an action to the chips. Takes and Recent sit below them.
5. **+ Reference:** a selection, a layer, a file or a Library image as a reference (chapter 12).
6. **Prompt.** An action that needs none says so.
7. **Suggest:** writes a prompt that fits the action and the size the result fills.
8. **Chips:** style, model and takes, each showing its value. The gear holds the quality level (Medium by default; Red Horizon's key art was made at High) and advanced options.
9. **The action button** with its price: Create image · 47 CU.

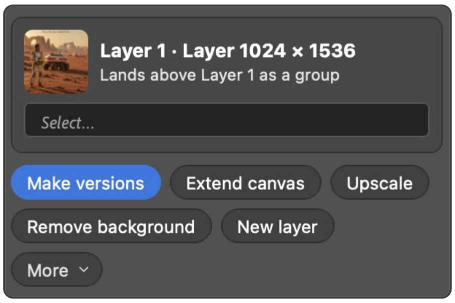
The panel menu, top right, holds Settings, Projects, Diagnostics, Help, About and Sign Out.

The panel reads what you are working on

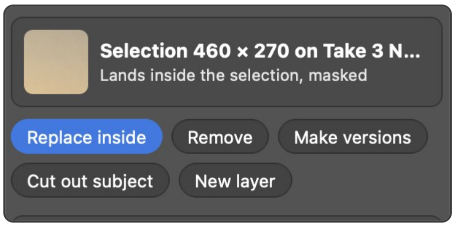
Click a layer, draw a selection or select a group of takes in the Layers panel, and the context card and its chips change with it. There is no mode to switch. After a run that is not masked to a selection, the new layer or group is selected, so the next action works on the result.


Blank canvas 1024 × 1536
Lands above Background at canvas size
Select...
Create image
Place from Library
Takes and recent runs on this document show here.

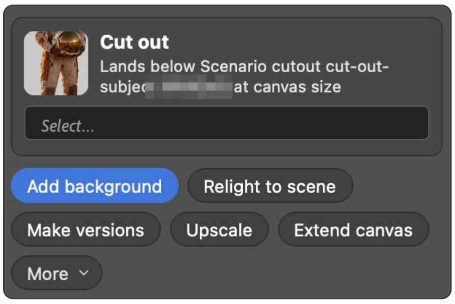
RED HORIZON **Blank canvas**, as File › New makes it: Create image, Place from Library.


Layer 1 · Layer 1024 × 1536
Lands above Layer 1 as a group
Select...
Make versions
Extend canvas
Upscale
Remove background
New layer
More

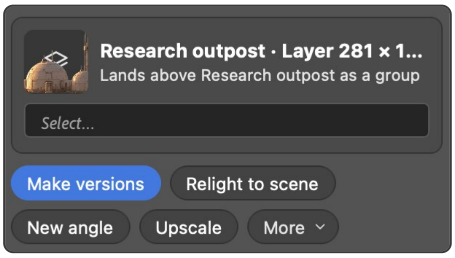
RED HORIZON **Layer**: the active layer, here the poster stamped to one layer (chapter 09).


Selection 460 × 270 on Take 3 N...
Lands inside the selection, masked
Replace inside
Remove
Make versions
Cut out subject
New layer

RED HORIZON **Selection**: "Selection 460 × 270 on Take 3 ..., lands inside the selection, masked".

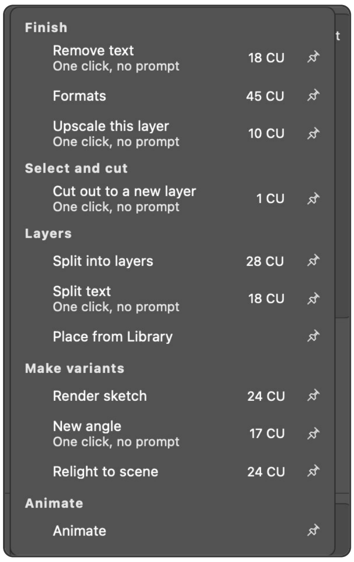

Cut out
Lands below Scenario cutout cut-out-subje[redacted]at canvas size
Select...
Add background
Relight to scene
Make versions
Upscale
Extend canvas
More

RED HORIZON **Cut-out**: a masked layer: Add background, Relight to scene. The layer's name is blurred.


Research outpost · Layer 281 × 1...
Lands above Research outpost as a group
Select...
Make versions
Relight to scene
New angle
Upscale
More

RED HORIZON **Split element**: a layer from Split into layers, here the research outpost.

A selected group of takes opens the **Takes** context (chapter 04). The chips follow the table below in every context.


Finish
Remove text
One click, no prompt
18 CU
Formats
45 CU
Upscale this layer
One click, no prompt
10 CU
Select and cut
Cut out to a new layer
One click, no prompt
1 CU
Layers
Split into layers
28 CU
Split text
One click, no prompt
18 CU
Place from Library
Make variants
Render sketch
24 CU
New angle
One click, no prompt
17 CU
Relight to scene
24 CU
Animate
Animate

RED HORIZON **More** on the key art: Finish, Select and cut, Layers, Make variants and Animate, each action with its price for this document.

Context	Chips, in order
Blank canvas	Create image, Place from Library
Flat image	Split into layers, Make versions, Upscale, Formats, More
Layer	Make versions, Extend canvas, Upscale, Remove background, New layer, More
Cut-out	Add background, Relight to scene, Make versions, Upscale, Extend canvas, More
Split element	Make versions, Relight to scene, New angle, Upscale, More
Selection	Replace inside, Remove, Make versions, Cut out subject, New layer
Takes	Compare takes, More like this, Refine, Upscale kept take, More

More lists the context's other actions, each with its price, in five groups: Finish (Remove text, Formats, Upscale this layer), Select and cut (Cut out to a new layer), Layers (Split into layers, Split text, Place from Library), Make variants (Render sketch, New angle, Relight to scene) and Animate. On Red Horizon's 1024 × 1536 key art it read Remove text 18 CU, Formats 45 CU, Upscale this layer 10 CU, Cut out to a new layer 1 CU, Split into layers 28 CU, Split text 18 CU, Render sketch 24 CU, New angle 17 CU and Relight to scene 24 CU.

With no document open the panel offers Create image and Open from Library, but Photoshop hides docked panels on its Home screen. With Photoshop in the background, the context card can show the previous document until the panel reads it again.

04 · CREATE

An empty document, *then four takes of the key art.*

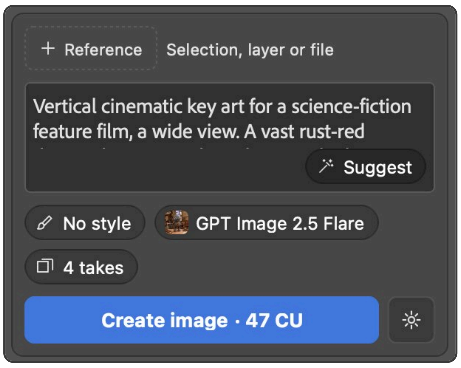
PHOTOSHOP
File › New: a 1024 × 1536 portrait canvas, one white Background.

+

SCENARIO
Create image with GPT Image 2.5 Flare at quality High, four takes, at the canvas's shape.

=

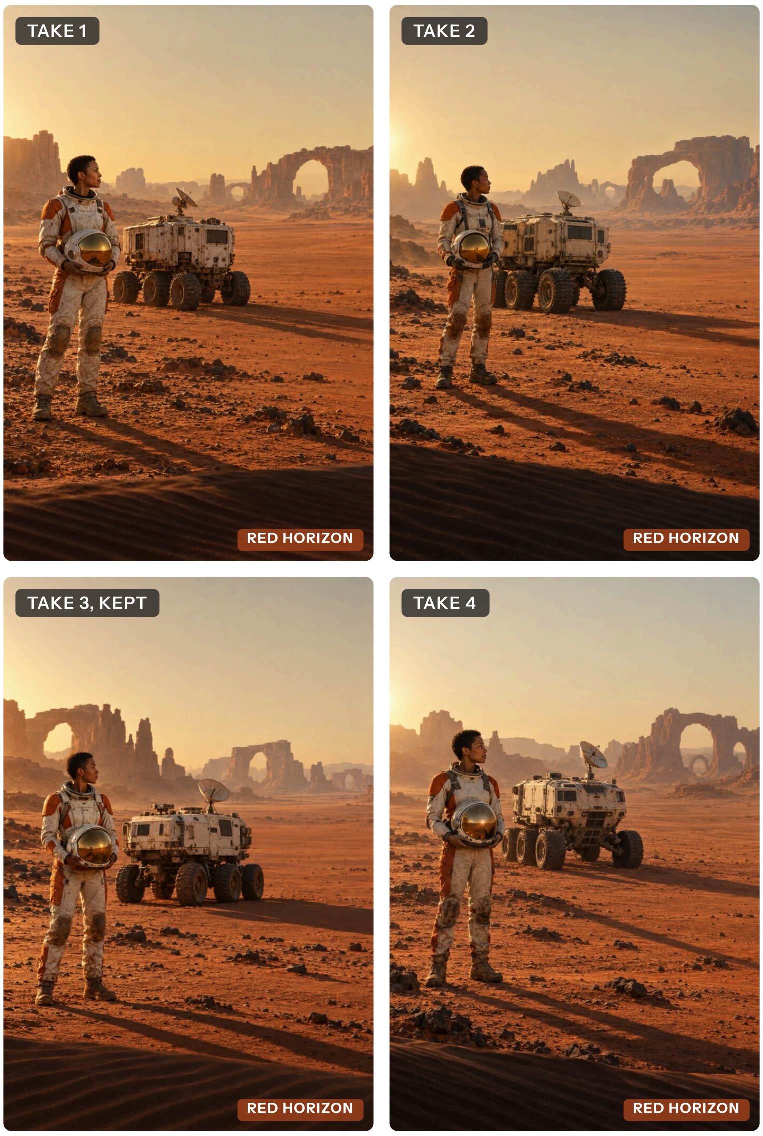
RESULT
Four takes as one group above the Background. Keep one; the others stay on disk.


+ Reference
Selection, layer or file
Suggest
No style
GPT Image 2.5 Flare
4 takes
Create image · 47 CU

Vertical cinematic key art for a science-fiction feature film, a wide view. A vast rust-red

RED HORIZON The prompt, No style, GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 4 takes, and the price on the button, at quality High.

The prompt asks for a wide view of a rust-red plain in the late afternoon, wind-carved arches in the distance, and the explorer full length on the left, holding her helmet in both hands at the waist. The helmet then sits in the same place in every view of the character sheet (chapter 06).

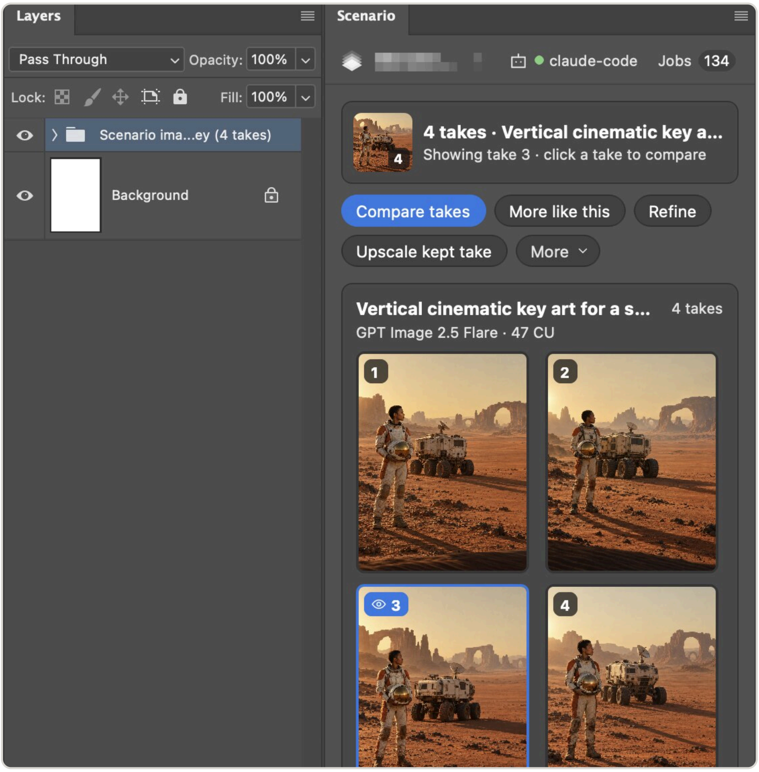

TAKE 1
RED HORIZON
TAKE 2
RED HORIZON
TAKE 3, KEPT
RED HORIZON
TAKE 4
RED HORIZON

The four takes of "Vertical cinematic key art for a science-fiction feature film, a wide view ...": the same explorer, rover and arches, composed four ways. Take 3 was kept.

1. Type what you want in the prompt, or click **Suggest**. The button shows the price once there is a prompt.
2. Click the button: **Create image · 47 CU**. The context card shows Queued, Generating 4 takes, Downloading.
3. The takes land as a group, take 1 visible, and the Takes card shows one tile per take. Click a tile to show that take in the document, then keep it.

Create image on a blank document: the context and its price **VERIFIED LIVE**, the landing as a layer above the Background **TESTED AUTOMATED**; the run pictured here landed as a group of takes above the Background.

Keep one take

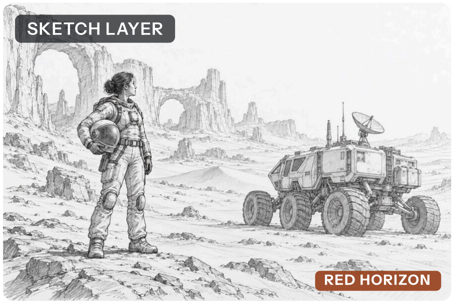

Layers
Pass Through
Opacity: 100%
Lock:
Fill: 100%
Scenario ima...ey (4 takes)
Background
Scenario
claude-code
Jobs 134
4
4 takes · Vertical cinematic key a...
Showing take 3 · click a take to compare
Compare takes
More like this
Refine
Upscale kept take
More
Vertical cinematic key art for a s...
4 takes
GPT Image 2.5 Flare · 47 CU
1
2
3
4

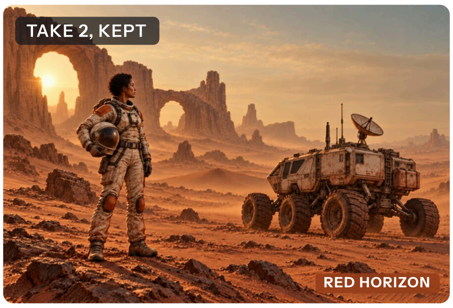
RED HORIZON After the run: the group "Scenario image … (4 takes)" above the Background, and the Takes card, "Showing take 3 · click a take to compare", GPT Image 2.5 Flare · 47 CU.

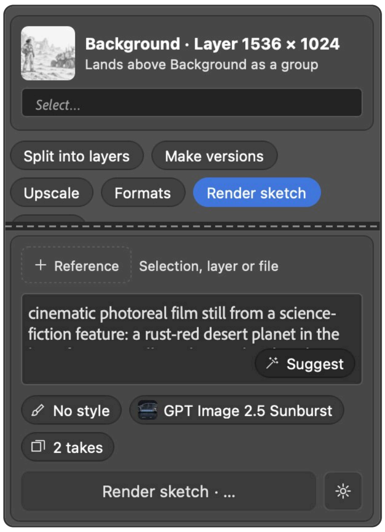
Show a take	Click its tile; the document shows that take, in one History state.
Keep take N	Removes the other takes from the document. Their files stay in the output folder and in Jobs.
More like this	Runs again with the shown take as a reference.
Refine	Keeps the shown take, loads its selection back and opens Replace inside on it.
Later	Select the group in the Layers panel, even after a restart, and the card comes back from the layers' metadata.

Or start from a sketch

Draw the layout in Photoshop, or place a scan, and choose **More › Make variants › Render sketch**. Describe the finish, or leave the prompt empty. The model keeps the drawing's layout: what was where in the sketch stays there.


SKETCH LAYER
RED HORIZON


TAKE 2, KEPT
RED HORIZON


Background · Layer 1536 × 1024
Lands above Background as a group
Select...
Split into layers
Make versions
Upscale
Formats
Render sketch
Reference
Selection, layer or file
Suggest
No style
GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst
2 takes
Render sketch · ...

cinematic photoreal film still from a science-fiction feature: a rust-red desert planet in the

RED HORIZON Render sketch on the sketch layer, GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst, 2 takes.

From Red Horizon's first shoot, before the key art above: a pencil layout of the explorer, the rover and the arches (itself generated for the shoot), rendered with GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst, best of 2 takes, Render sketch · 24 CU. The figure, the rover and the arches keep their places.

05 · SELECT

Photoshop draws the selection, *Scenario fills it.*

PHOTOSHOP
Select › Modify › Expand and Feather on the selection Scenario found; the Lasso around an empty patch of plain or sea.

+

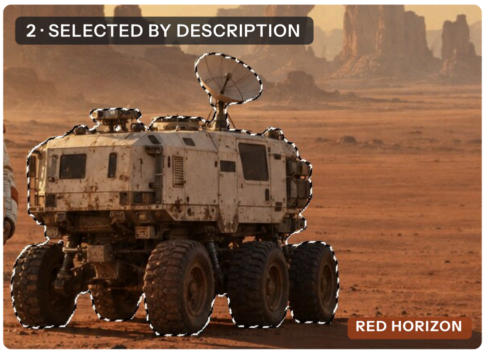
SCENARIO
Select by description (SAM 3.1 Image), then Replace inside: Bolder or Inside selection.

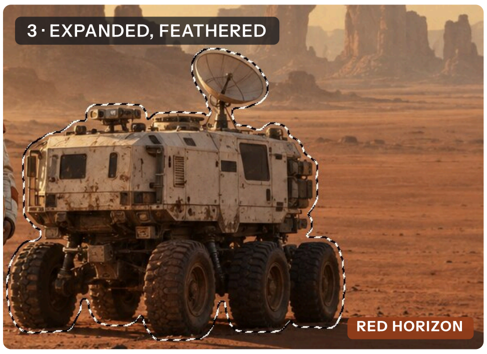
=

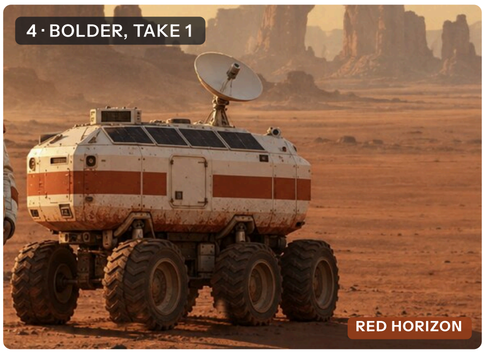
RESULT
New elements on their own layers, masked to the selection. Everything outside stays as it was.

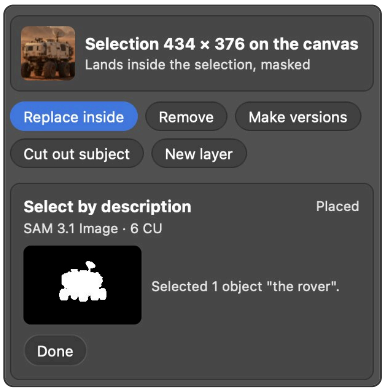
The rover in the expedition's colours

1 · THE ROVER
RED HORIZON


2 · SELECTED BY DESCRIPTION

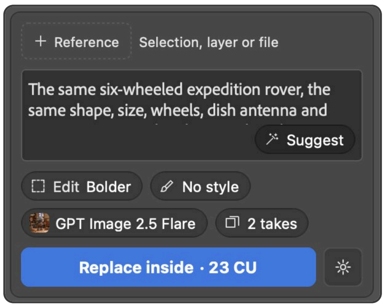

3 · EXPANDED, FEATHERED


4 · BOLDER, TAKE 1


Selection 434 × 376 on the canvas
Lands inside the selection, masked

Select by description Placed
SAM 3.1 Image · 6 CU
Selected 1 object "the rover".

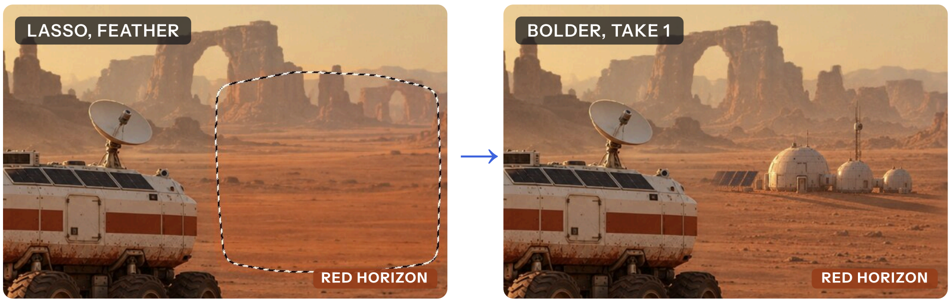
RED HORIZON "the rover" typed in **Select…**: SAM 3.1 Image found 1 object, 6 CU; the context card reads "Selection 434 × 376 on the canvas".


The same six-wheeled expedition rover, the same shape, size, wheels, dish antenna and
Edit Bolder
No style
GPT Image 2.5 Flare
2 takes

RED HORIZON Edit Bolder, GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes.

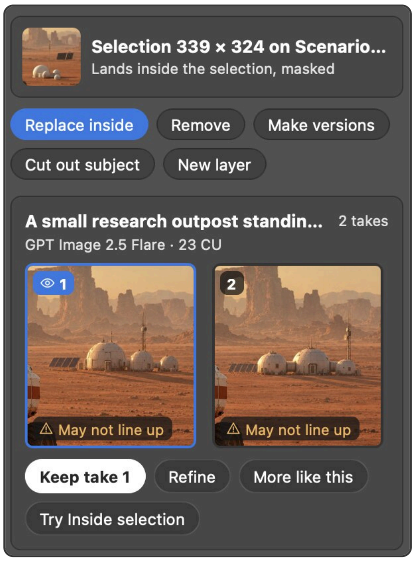
1. Type what to select in the context card's **Select…** field, here "the rover", and click **Select**. The masks the model finds become one Photoshop selection.
2. Photoshop: **Select › Modify › Expand**, then **Feather**, so the new paint has room and a soft edge.
3. Choose **Replace inside**, set **Edit** to **Bolder**, and describe the change: "The same six-wheeled expedition rover, the same shape, size, wheels, dish antenna and position, repainted in the expedition's colours …". **Replace inside · 23 CU**.
4. Bolder lets the change reach past the selection, and the layer mask grows to keep it whole. Take 1 was kept: the dusty rover in white and burnt orange, solar panels on its roof, its shape and shadow unchanged. **Try Inside selection** runs the other mode on the same selection.

An outpost on the empty plain


LASSO, FEATHER
RED HORIZON
→
BOLDER, TAKE 1
RED HORIZON

The Lasso around an empty patch of plain behind the rover, feathered, then "A small research outpost standing on the open plain in the middle distance, at true scale and distance, a little smaller than the rover …". Bolder with GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes, Replace inside · 23 CU: three white domes, a mast and a row of solar panels, lit from the left like the rover, their shadows falling the same way.

Two earlier tries with Inside selection on Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit were not kept: the first drew the outpost without shadows, the second with shadows too short for the low sun. Bolder, with the light written into the prompt, gave the take above.



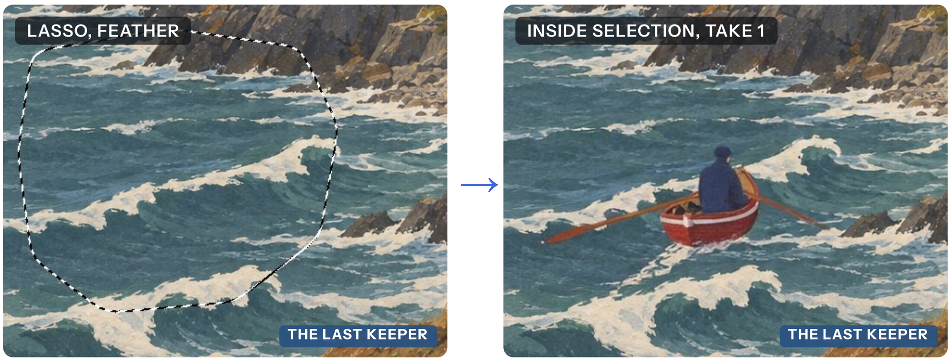
Selection 339 × 324 on Scenario…
Lands inside the selection, masked

A small research outpost standin… 2 takes
GPT Image 2.5 Flare · 23 CU

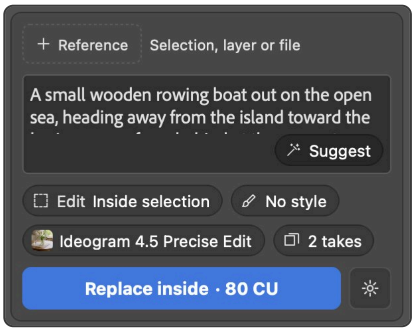
Replace inside
Remove
Make versions
Cut out subject
New layer
1
2
⚠ May not line up
⚠ May not line up
Keep take 1
Refine
More like this
Try Inside selection

RED HORIZON Two takes, both marked **May not line up**, as expected with Bolder; **Keep take 1**, Refine, More like this, Try Inside selection.

A rowing boat on the sea, with Inside selection


LASSO, FEATHER
THE LAST KEEPER
→
INSIDE SELECTION, TAKE 1
THE LAST KEEPER

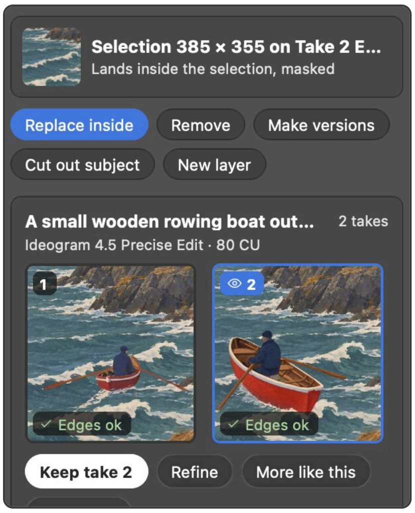
The Lasso on the open sea below the cliffs, then "A small wooden rowing boat out on the open sea, heading away from the island …". Inside selection on Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit, the model the panel recommends for Replace inside, 2 takes, both marked **Edges ok**, Replace inside · 80 CU. The boat stays inside the lasso's shape; the cliffs outside are untouched.



A small wooden rowing boat out on the open sea, heading away from the island toward the

+ Reference
Selection, layer or file
Suggest
Edit Inside selection
No style
Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit
2 takes
Replace inside · 80 CU

THE LAST KEEPER Edit Inside selection, Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit, 2 takes.



Selection 385 × 355 on Take 2 E…

Lands inside the selection, masked

A small wooden rowing boat out…

Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit · 80 CU

THE LAST KEEPER The two takes, take 2 shown here to compare; take 1 was kept.

Edit	What it does
Inside selection	Changes only what is inside the selection (Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit). Good for a change that fits the shape you drew. An object taller than the selection is cut at its edge.
Bolder	A stronger change (GPT Image 2.5 Flare). The new subject may reach past the selection, and the mask of each take grows over what the model drew outside. Good when the new object is larger than the old one.
Remove	A chip of the selection context: removes what is inside and fills it with what should be behind. No prompt (Ideogram 4.5).

Check badges on a take

Edges ok	No step in tone or alignment found around the edge. A hint, not a guarantee: look at 100% before you keep.
Edge may show	A lighter or darker patch at the selection edge, or on Extend canvas a step or a repeated detail at the old edge.
May not line up	The new pixels do not line up with the old ones at the edge (expected with Bolder).
Part unchanged, Spills past	Part of the selection stayed as it was, or the change spilled past the selection.

Tips. Leave some margin around the object and feather the edge. With Inside selection, draw the selection to the size of the new object, or use Bolder. Write the light into the prompt (where the sun is, which way shadows fall) so the new element sits in the scene. A reference of the whole scene can be copied into the selection: use an object or a style as the reference.

06 · CHARACTER

Cut her out, draw her from every side, *lay out the sheet.*

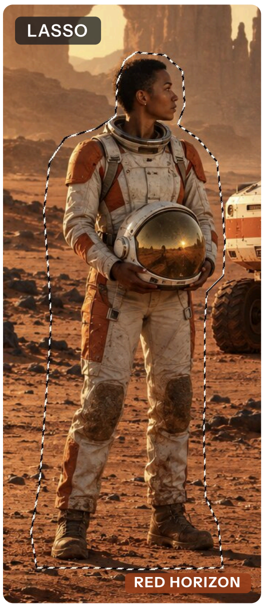
PHOTOSHOP
The Lasso around the explorer; a new sheet with type labels; the Rectangular Marquee for her helmet.

+

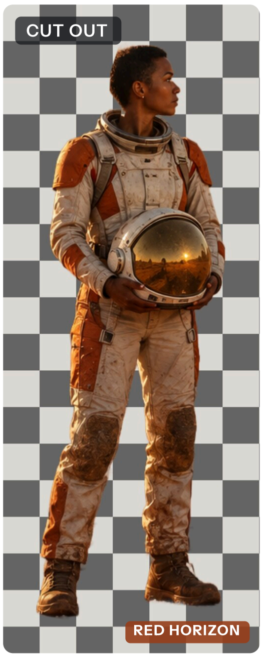
SCENARIO
Cut out subject, Make versions for each view, Remove background on each kept take, New layer inside the marquee.

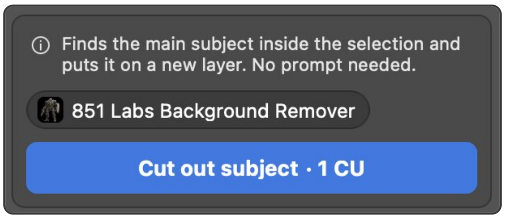
=

RESULT
A character sheet: front, three-quarter, side and back views, her helmet, and labels that stay live type.



→




ⓘ Finds the main subject inside the selection and puts it on a new layer. No prompt needed.

RED HORIZON "Finds the main subject inside the selection and puts it on its own layer. No prompt needed." 851 Labs Background Remover.

A loose lasso around the explorer is enough: **Cut out subject** finds her inside it and puts her on a new layer with a transparent background, shown here on a checkerboard. The original layer stays as it was and the selection is dropped, in one History state. The cut keeps the selection's own shape, a lasso or an ellipse, not only its box **TESTED AUTOMATED**.

The panel switches to the **cut-out context** (chapter 03):

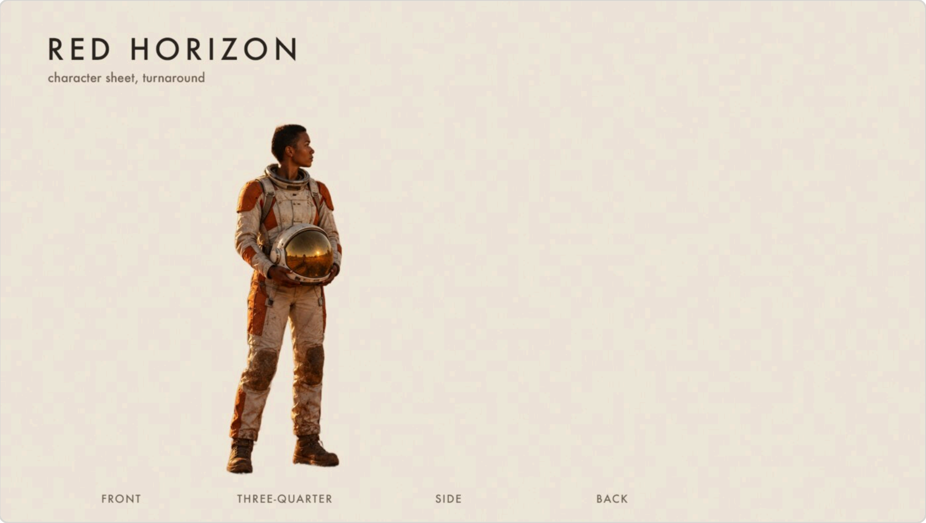
- **Add background** : describe a scene; it lands below the layer at canvas size.
- **Relight to scene** : relights the layer to match what is under it (chapter 07).
- Make versions, Upscale, Extend canvas.

Or copy the layer to another document with **Layer › Duplicate Layer**, mask included: here, onto the character sheet as her three-quarter view.

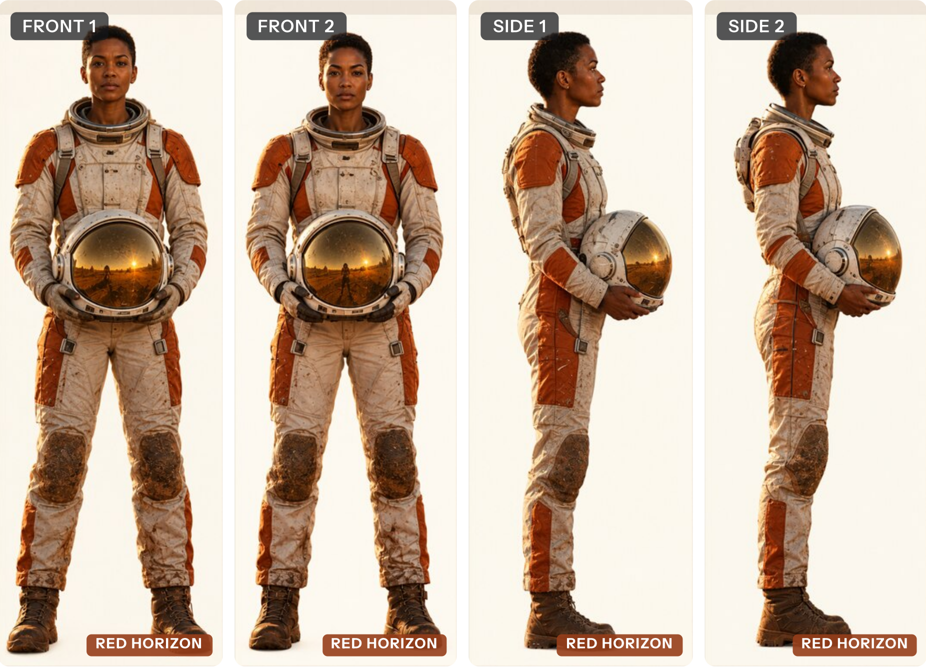
Remove background on a layer does the same cut in place, as a mask; **Cut out to a new layer** (More) keeps the layer and puts the subject on a masked copy above.

Front, side and back with Make versions

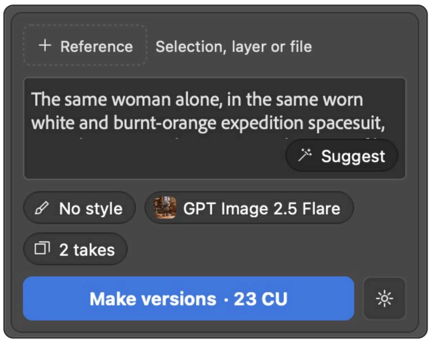
The sheet is a Photoshop document: a cream background, the cut-out explorer copied in, and type layers for the title and the labels. With her layer active, **Make versions** draws her again from the view the prompt names: "The same woman alone, in the same worn white and burnt-orange expedition spacesuit, turned to face the viewer: a full front view ...", then a true 90° side profile, then a back view. Each prompt keeps the helmet in both hands at the waist.


RED HORIZON
character sheet, turnaround
FRONT
THREE-QUARTER
SIDE
BACK

RED HORIZON The sheet before the views: the cut-out three-quarter figure and the live type.

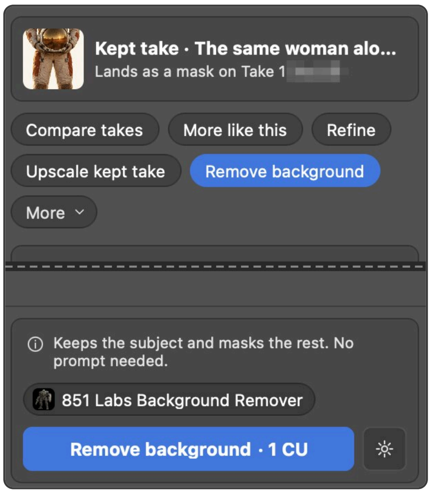

FRONT 1
RED HORIZON
FRONT 2
RED HORIZON
SIDE 1
RED HORIZON
SIDE 2
RED HORIZON

Two takes of the front view and two of the side view, GPT Image 2.5 Flare. The suit, the stripes and the helmet held at the waist stay the same from take to take.


+ Reference
Selection, layer or file
Suggest
No style
GPT Image 2.5 Flare
2 takes
Make versions · 23 CU

The same woman alone, in the same worn white and burnt-orange expedition spacesuit,

RED HORIZON The prompt names the view. GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes, **Make versions · 23 CU**.


Kept take · The same woman alo...
Compare takes
More like this
Refine
Upscale kept take
Remove background
More
851 Labs Background Remover
Remove background · 1 CU

Lands as a mask on Take 1 [redacted]

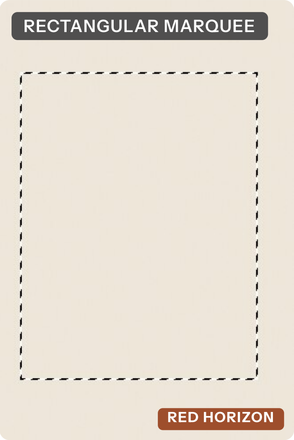
Keeps the subject and masks the rest. No prompt needed.

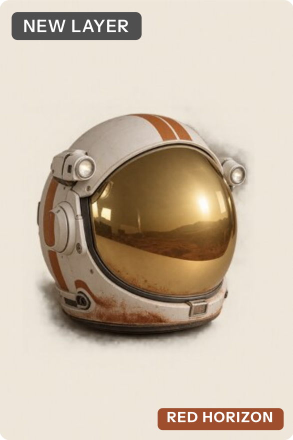
RED HORIZON On the kept take, **Remove background**: "Keeps the subject and masks the rest." **Remove background · 1 CU**. The take's id is blurred.

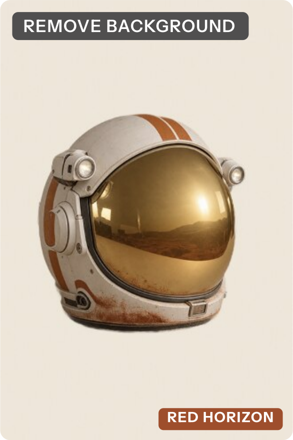
On a kept take, **Remove background** and **New angle** work on the take that is showing **VERIFIED LIVE**. Remove background lands as a mask on the layer, so the hidden pixels stay and you can paint the mask. Then place each view on the sheet's ground line with **Edit › Free Transform**; a new mask starts hidden, so no line of the old background shows along the edge **VERIFIED LIVE**.

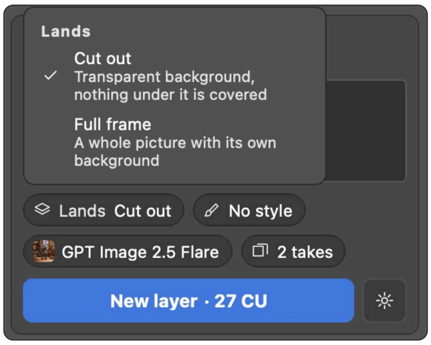
> New angle (More › Make variants) turns a figure without a prompt: pick **Turn left 45°**, **Turn right 45°**, **Side view**, **Back view** or **From above** (Qwen Edit Multiangle 2511; 17 CU in More on Red Horizon's key art). Neither example used it: Red Horizon's views were made with Make versions and a prompt that names the view, so each view keeps the helmet in her hands.

Her helmet inside a marquee


RECTANGULAR MARQUEE
RED HORIZON


NEW LAYER
RED HORIZON


REMOVE BACKGROUND
RED HORIZON

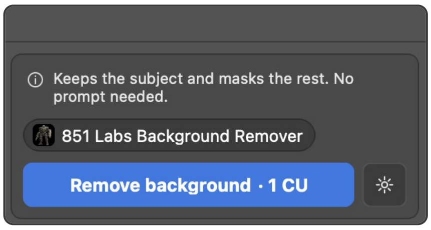

Lands
✓ Cut out
Transparent background, nothing under it is covered
Full frame
A whole picture with its own background
Lands Cut out
No style
GPT Image 2.5 Flare
2 takes
New layer · 27 CU

RED HORIZON **Lands**: Cut out, or Full frame. GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes, New layer · 27 CU.

Draw a 400 × 520 marquee where the prop goes, choose **New layer** and describe it: "her round expedition helmet on its own: a big round white helmet with a gold mirrored visor and burnt-orange stripes matching her suit ...". The take is sized to the selection and placed inside it VERIFIED LIVE.

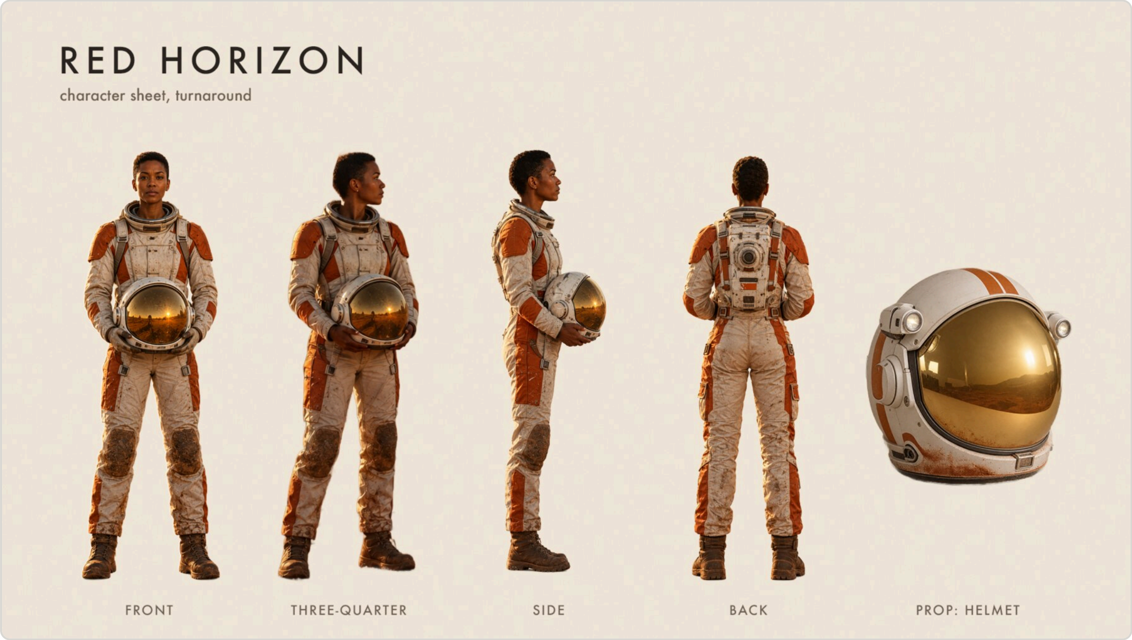
Lands: Cut out (the default) asks the model for a transparent background. When the model still returns a full picture, Photoshop's own Remove Background cuts it at placement, as a layer mask you can paint. **Full frame** keeps the model's background inside the selection box.

On this run the helmet landed with a soft grey halo around it. **Remove background** on the layer, 1 CU, cleared it; then a type layer, PROP: HELMET, went under it.


Keeps the subject and masks the rest. No prompt needed.
851 Labs Background Remover
Remove background · 1 CU

RED HORIZON Remove background on the helmet layer, Remove background · 1 CU.

Without a selection, New layer makes a new image on a layer above the active one.


RED HORIZON
character sheet, turnaround
FRONT
THREE-QUARTER
SIDE
BACK
PROP: HELMET

RED HORIZON The finished sheet: front, three-quarter, side and back views and the helmet, each on its own layer, with the labels still live type.

07 · LAYERS

One flat picture, *rebuilt as layers you can change.*

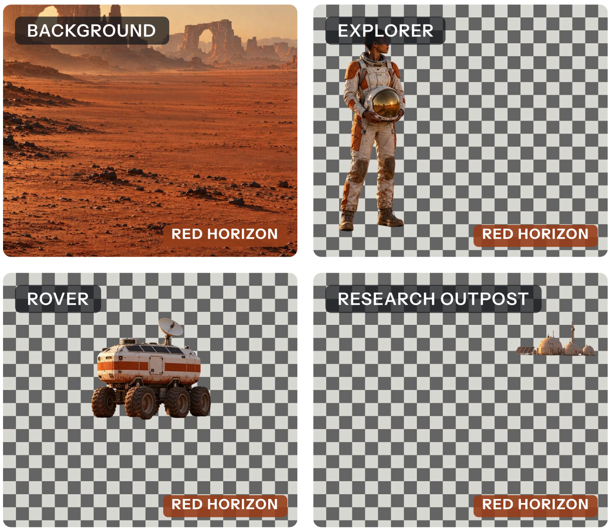
PHOTOSHOP
A layer mask to bring the shadows back; Free Transform; Hue/Saturation masked to a selection or clipped to a layer.

+

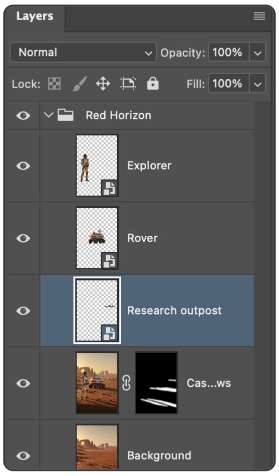
SCENARIO
Split into layers (Seedream 5.0 Flash Layerize): a clean background and one layer per element. Select by description for the colour.

=

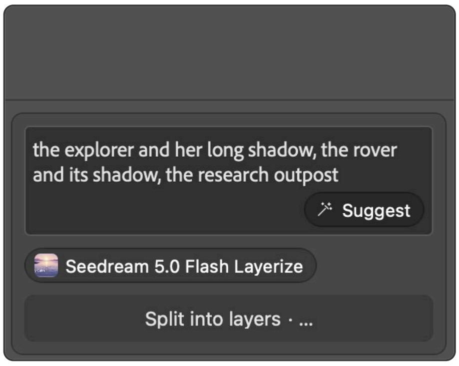
RESULT
The key art as layers, its stripes recoloured with one adjustment you can change at any time.


BACKGROUND
RED HORIZON
EXPLORER
RED HORIZON
ROVER
RED HORIZON
RESEARCH OUTPOST
RED HORIZON

The four layers that came back, on a checkerboard; in Photoshop each sits where it was in the frame. The background is a clean plate, with the explorer, the rover and the outpost taken out.


Layers
Normal
Opacity: 100%
Lock:
Fill: 100%
Red Horizon
Explorer
Rover
Research outpost
Cas...ws
Background

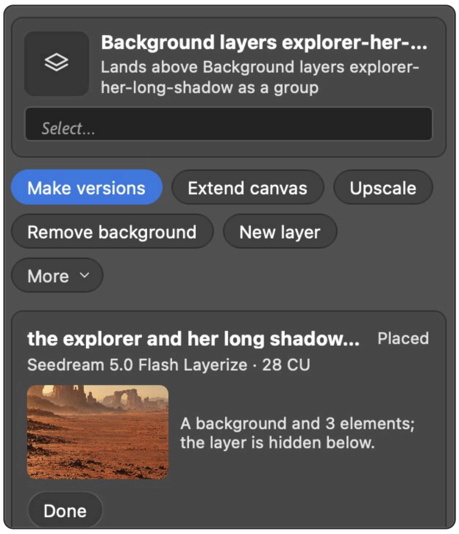
RED HORIZON The three elements, renamed, above the Cast shadows layer and the clean Background.



the explorer and her long shadow, the rover and its shadow, the research outpost

Suggest
Seedream 5.0 Flash Layerize
Split into layers · ...

RED HORIZON The prompt lists the elements: "the explorer and her long shadow, the rover and its shadow, the research outpost".



Background layers explorer-her-...
Lands above Background layers explorer-her-long-shadow as a group

Select...
Make versions
Extend canvas
Upscale
Remove background
New layer
More

the explorer and her long shadow... Placed
Seedream 5.0 Flash Layerize · 28 CU
A background and 3 elements; the layer is hidden below.

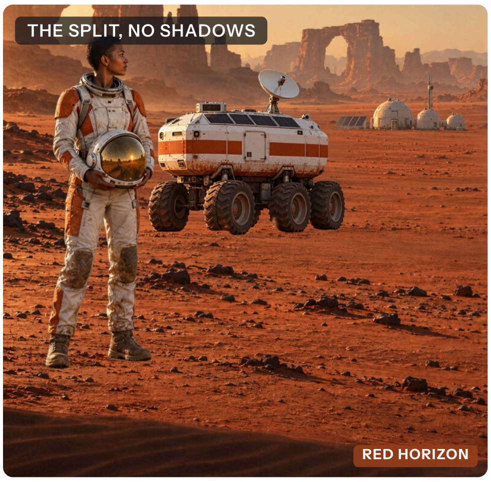
Done

RED HORIZON "A background and 3 elements; the layer is hidden below." Seedream 5.0 Flash Layerize · 28 CU.

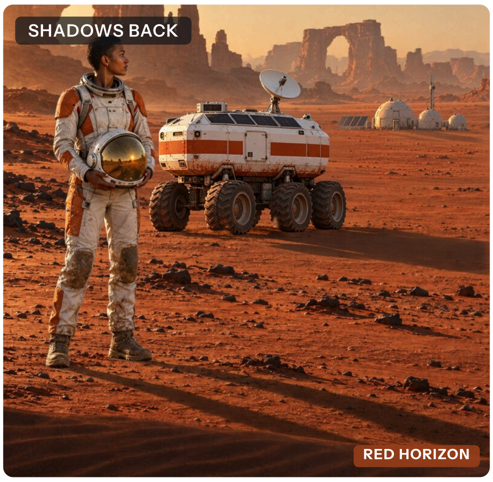
- On a flat image, **Split into layers** is the first chip; on a layer it is in More › Layers. Leave the prompt empty for the main elements, or list them. **Split into layers · 28 CU**.
- The result is a group above the source: a clean background and one layer per element, named Element 1, 2, ... in the model's order, not the prompt's (here Element 1 the outpost, 2 the rover, 3 the explorer). The source layer is hidden below.
- Look at every element at 100%: one redrawn differently from the picture can land in the wrong place without a note.

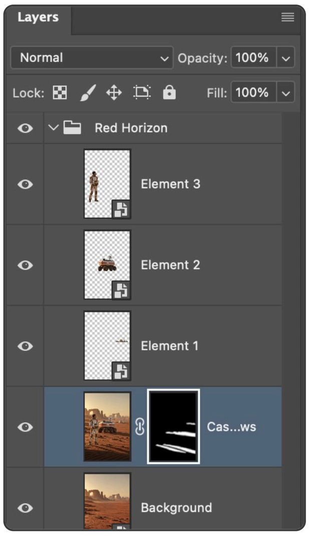
The cast shadows, back from the original

On Red Horizon every run of Split into layers, four in all on Seedream 5.0 Flash and Pro Layerize, left the long cast shadows out: the elements came back without them and the clean background has none, even with the shadows named in the prompt. Photoshop brings them back in a few steps.


THE SPLIT, NO SHADOWS
RED HORIZON

→


SHADOWS BACK
RED HORIZON

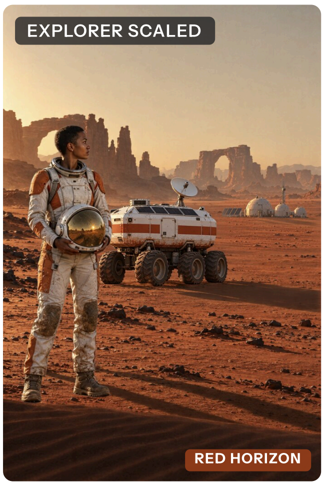

Layers
Lock:
Red Horizon
Element 3
Element 2
Element 1
Cas...ws
Background

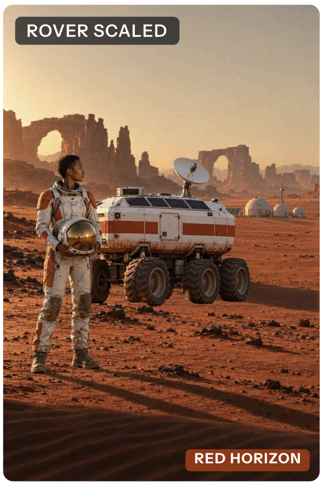
Normal
Opacity: 100%
Fill: 100%

RED HORIZON Element 1 to 3 as the split named them, and **Cast shadows** with its mask.

1. Copy the original key art to a new layer above the Background and name it Cast shadows.
2. With the **Lasso**, select each shadow on the sand, then **Select › Modify › Feather**.
3. **Layer › Layer Mask › Reveal Selection**: only the shadows of the original show through, under the elements.

Free Transform on one element


EXPLORER SCALED
RED HORIZON

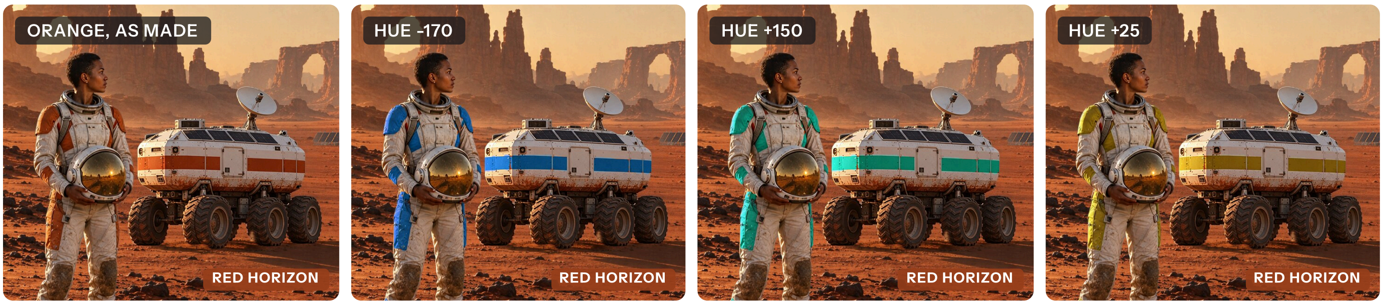

ROVER SCALED
RED HORIZON

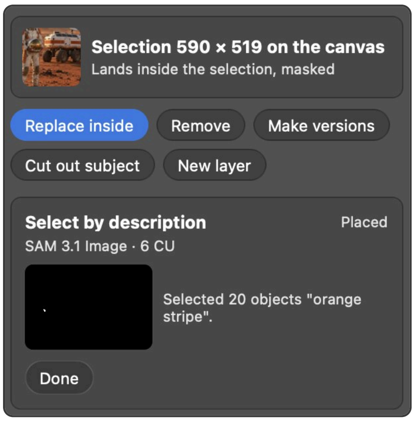
Each element is its own layer, so **Edit › Free Transform** scales or moves one without touching the others: here the explorer, then the rover, scaled up.

The cast shadows stay at their size, since they are a layer of their own: a scaled element no longer matches its shadow. On Red Horizon each element went back to 100% before the next one, and the poster keeps the original sizes.

> **Relight to scene.** For a cut-out or a split element, More › Make variants › Relight to scene relights the layer to match what is visible under it, masked to its outline (GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst). It can redraw details, so name what must stay in the prompt and look at every take at 100% before you keep one. Neither example used it.

The orange stripes in a new colour, in one adjustment

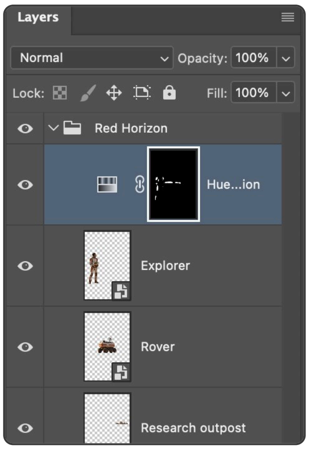

ORANGE, AS MADE
RED HORIZON
HUE -170
RED HORIZON
HUE +150
RED HORIZON
HUE +25
RED HORIZON


Replace inside
Remove
Make versions
Cut out subject
New layer
Placed
Done

Selection 590 × 519 on the canvas
Lands inside the selection, masked

Select by description
SAM 3.1 Image · 6 CU
Selected 20 objects "orange stripe".

RED HORIZON "orange stripe" in **Select…**: SAM 3.1 Image selected 20 objects across her suit and the rover, 6 CU.

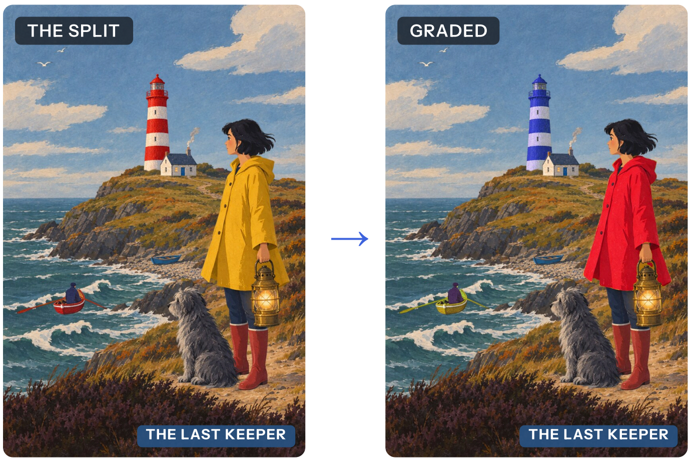

Layers
Lock:
Red Horizon
Hue...ion
Explorer
Rover
Research outpost

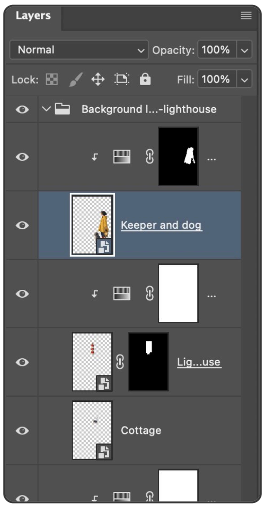
Normal · Opacity: 100% · Fill: 100%

RED HORIZON One Hue/Saturation layer, masked to that selection, above the elements.

1. Type "orange stripe" in **Select…**. The model finds every stripe, on her suit and on the rover, and makes them one selection.
2. **Layer › New Adjustment Layer › Hue/Saturation**: the selection becomes the adjustment's mask.
3. Drag Hue: -170 for blue, +150 for teal, +25 for yellow. The pixels stay as they were; change the value, or delete the adjustment, at any time.

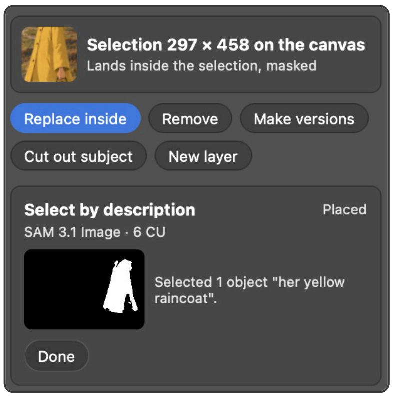
The Last Keeper: one adjustment per element


THE SPLIT
THE LAST KEEPER
→
GRADED
THE LAST KEEPER


Layers
Lock:
Background l...-lighthouse
...
Keeper and dog
...
Lig...use
Cottage

Normal · Opacity: 100% · Fill: 100%

THE LAST KEEPER Hue/Saturation layers clipped to their elements.


Replace inside
Remove
Make versions
Cut out subject
New layer
Placed
Done

Selection 297 × 458 on the canvas
Lands inside the selection, masked

Select by description
SAM 3.1 Image · 6 CU
Selected 1 object "her yellow raincoat".

THE LAST KEEPER "her yellow raincoat" selected by description, 6 CU.

On The Last Keeper the split gave the lighthouse, the cottage, the keeper and her dog, and the rowing boat as layers. A Hue/Saturation layer made with **Use Previous Layer to Create Clipping Mask** changes one element only: the lighthouse turned navy, and her coat, selected by description, turned red. Each value stays editable.

On this picture Split into layers placed the lighthouse 58 px off its place. It was moved back with **Move** and its edge tidied with a layer mask before the grade. Compare each element with the original before you build on it.

08 · FORMATS

Live type, *four formats, nothing cropped that matters.*

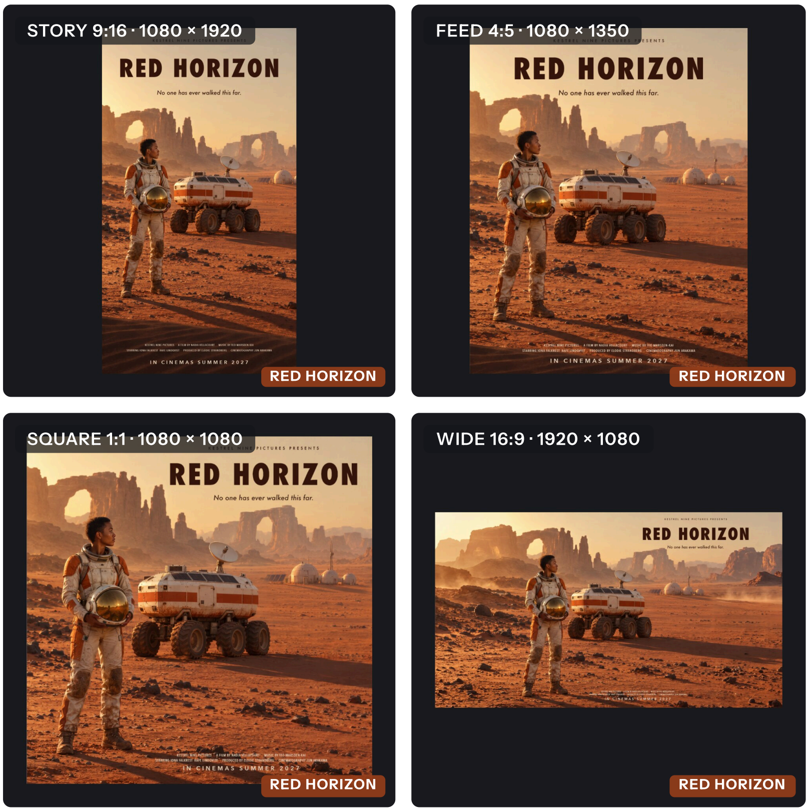
PHOTOSHOP
The Type tool: six live type layers over the art; then Move to nudge a line.

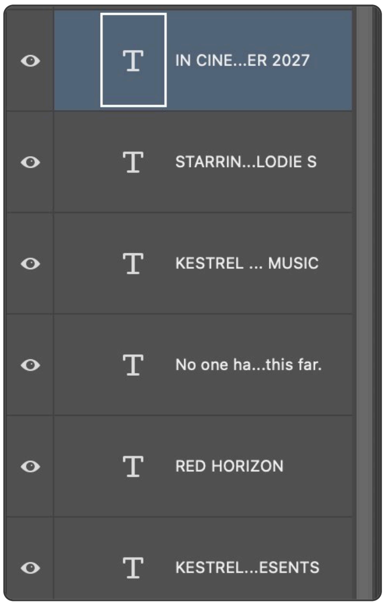
+

SCENARIO
Formats (Smart Reframe): Story, Feed, Square and Wide, with a prompt for what must stay in frame.

=

RESULT
One formats document, an artboard per format, each line of type laid out again, still editable.


STORY 9:16 · 1080 × 1920
RED HORIZON
FEED 4:5 · 1080 × 1350
RED HORIZON
SQUARE 1:1 · 1080 × 1080
RED HORIZON
WIDE 16:9 · 1920 × 1080
RED HORIZON


IN CINE...ER 2027
STARRIN...LODIE S
KESTREL ... MUSIC
No one ha...this far.
RED HORIZON
KESTREL...ESENTS

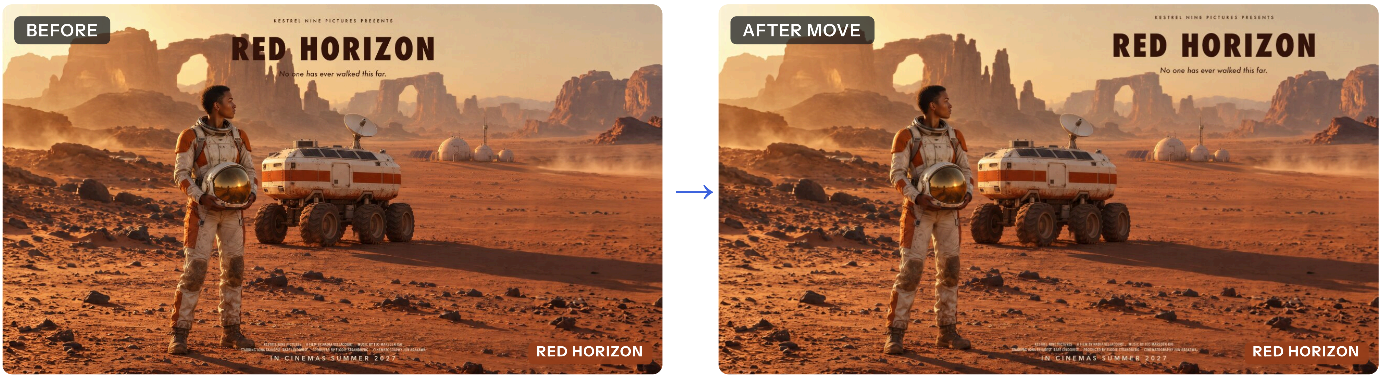
RED HORIZON The poster's six type layers: studio line, title, tagline, two billing lines, release line.

The four artboards, shown here at the same scale in equal cells, after the Move pass below. The explorer, the rover and the outpost stay in each frame, at their size; the 9:16 frame cuts the outpost's leftmost dome at its edge, as Smart Reframe delivered it.

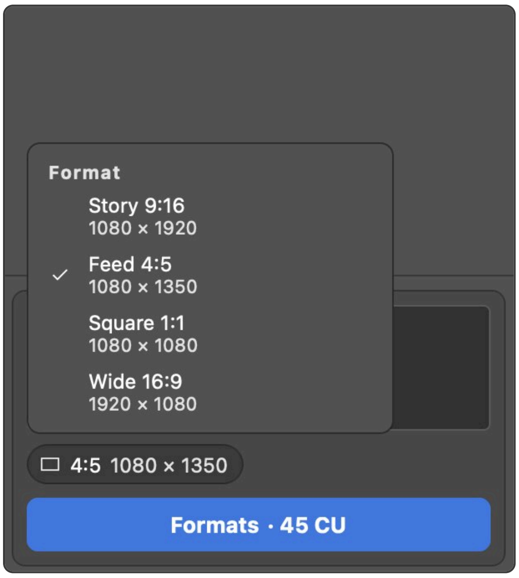
1. Set the poster's lines with the **Type tool** and keep them as type layers.
2. Select the art and choose **Formats** (a chip on a flat image, More › Finish on a layer). Pick the format in the **Format** chip.
3. Optional: say what must stay in frame, "Keep the explorer, the rover and the research outpost whole in frame, at their size". Click **Formats · 45 CU**.
4. The picture is reframed without its type layers. Each line is laid out again on the artboard at its place in the frame, scaled with the picture, smaller only when it would not fit. Run the next format: it is added to the same document.

Formats with live titles VERIFIED LIVE on 0.7.1 (four artboards in one document, each title inside its artboard); the placement rule that keeps the title's place in the frame changed after that run TESTED AUTOMATED. Text painted into the pixels is reframed with the picture and can still be cut: use Split text first (below).

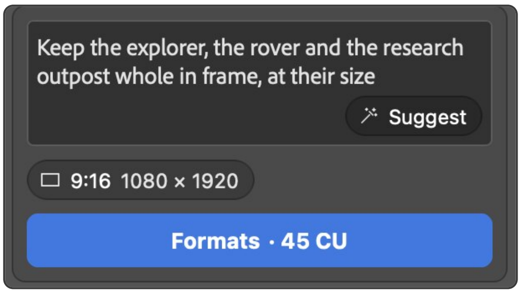
Then Photoshop: Move a line


BEFORE
KESTREL NINE PICTURES PRESENTS
RED HORIZON
No one has ever walked this far.
IN CINEMAS SUMMER 2027
RED HORIZON
AFTER MOVE
KESTREL NINE PICTURES PRESENTS
RED HORIZON
No one has ever walked this far.
IN CINEMAS SUMMER 2027
RED HORIZON

Formats keeps each line at its place in the frame; on a wide frame that place can land on busy picture. On the 1:1 and 16:9 artboards a few lines were moved with the **Move** tool: off the rocks, and the billing lines off her boots. They stay live type.


Format
Story 9:16
1080 × 1920
✓ Feed 4:5
1080 × 1350
Square 1:1
1080 × 1080
Wide 16:9
1920 × 1080
☐ 4:5 1080 × 1350
Formats · 45 CU

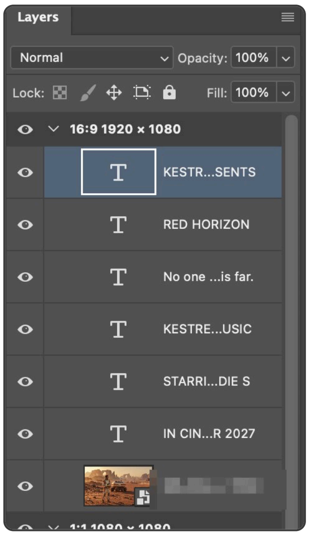
RED HORIZON The **Format** menu: Story 9:16, Feed 4:5, Square 1:1, Wide 16:9.



Keep the explorer, the rover and the research outpost whole in frame, at their size

Suggest
☐ 9:16 1080 × 1920
Formats · 45 CU

RED HORIZON The prompt says what must stay whole; 9:16 1080 × 1920, `Formats · 45 CU`.


Layers
Normal
Opacity: 100%
Lock:
Fill: 100%
16:9 1920 × 1080
KESTR...SENTS
RED HORIZON
No one ...is far.
KESTRE...USIC
STARRI...DIE S
IN CIN...R 2027
1:1 1080 × 1080

RED HORIZON The formats document: the 16:9 artboard and its six live type layers. The image layer's name is blurred.

Extend canvas

To grow the poster itself to a wider ratio, keep its pixels and draw only the new area: **Extend canvas** (a chip on a layer, More › Finish on a flat image). Pick the target in `Extend to`; the canvas's own ratio is left out.

The default model, Reframe, redraws the frame around the original and has no per-side growth; for `+20% each side`, pick GPT Image 2.5 Flare. Neither example used it.

> Look at the old edges at 100%. Extend canvas can show a step at the old edge or draw a figure a second time; the checks flag a step or a repeated detail but do not remove it. Extend in smaller steps if you see one.

> Split text and Remove text. When a title is painted into the pixels, a flattened file or a client's JPEG, **More › Layers › Split text** gives a clean base without the title and the title on its own layer above, masked where the source differs from the base (Ideogram V3 Layerize Text). **Remove text** (More › Finish) gives only the clean base, as a new layer above. Both are one click, no prompt. Neither example needed them: their type was set with the Type tool and stayed live.

09 · PRINT

Twice the pixels, *in a document of its own.*

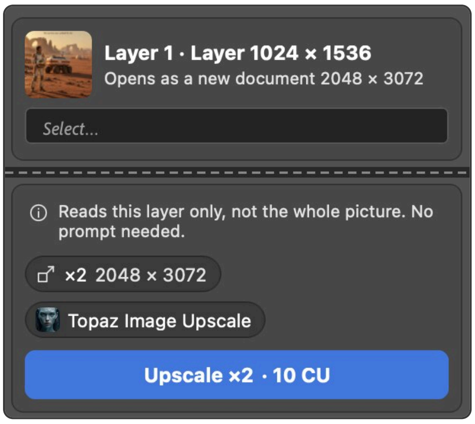
PHOTOSHOP
Stamp Visible, Shift+Option+Command+E: the poster, type included, merged into one new layer. Image › Image Size to read the print size.

+

SCENARIO
Upscale this layer, ×2, Topaz Image Upscale.

=

RESULT
A new 2048 × 3072 document: 17.3 × 26 cm at 300 ppi.

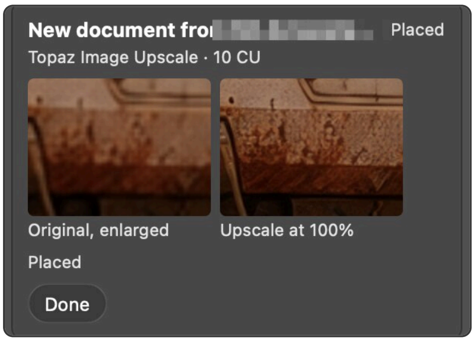


Layer 1 · Layer 1024 × 1536

Opens as a new document 2048 × 3072

Reads this layer only, not the whole picture. No prompt needed.

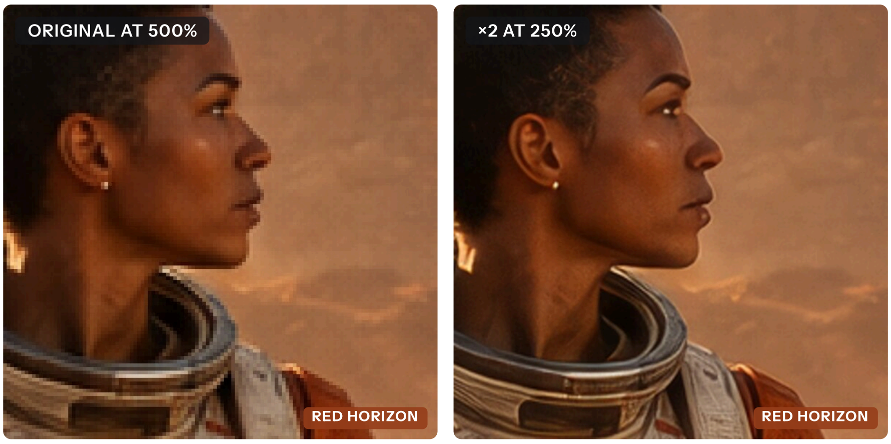
RED HORIZON "Opens as a new document 2048 × 3072. Reads this layer only, not the whole picture. No prompt needed." ×2, Topaz Image Upscale, **Upscale ×2 · 10 CU**.



New document fro[redacted]

Topaz Image Upscale · 10 CU

RED HORIZON The result card compares the original, enlarged, with the upscale at 100%. The document's name is blurred.



Her face at the same size on the page: the 1024 × 1536 original enlarged, and the ×2 document.

- **Upscale this layer** (More › Finish on a layer) reads the active layer only. On Red Horizon the poster was first stamped to one layer, so the type is in the upscale too. **Upscale** on a flat image reads all visible layers. **Upscale kept take** on a takes group upscales the take you kept.
- The result opens as a new document named after the source **VERIFIED LIVE** . The source document is untouched.
- Topaz Image Upscale offers ×2 and its other factors. Models with no factor setting (P-Image Upscale, Recraft Crisp Upscale) show none.
- To keep the type live instead, upscale the art without it, then drag the type layers into the ×2 document and scale them 200%. Type stays sharp at any size.

The 4 MB upload limit

Every upload stays under 4,000,000 bytes as sent. A capture over the limit is reduced in 10% steps; since an upscale's size follows its source, the panel stops first and shows the new size and price, and the next click runs at that size. Nothing is sent or spent before. **VERIFIED LIVE**

10 · MOTION

The key art in motion, *without its type.*

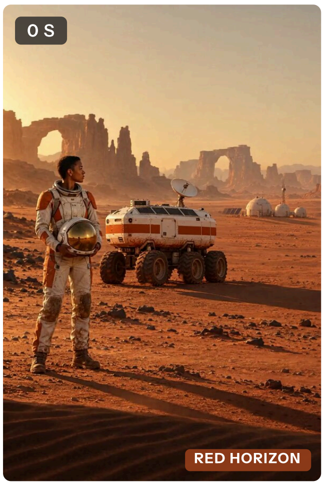
PHOTOSHOP
The Timeline: the clip opens as a video document you can trim and render.

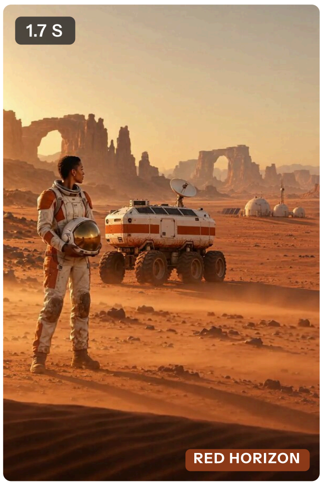
+

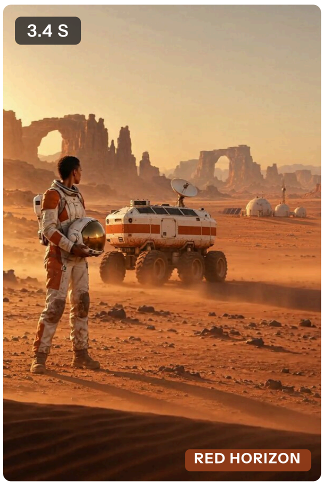
SCENARIO
Animate: a short clip from the picture and your prompt.

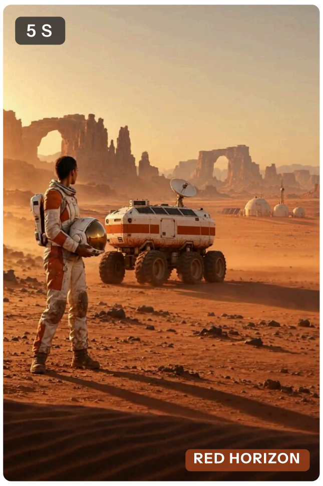
=

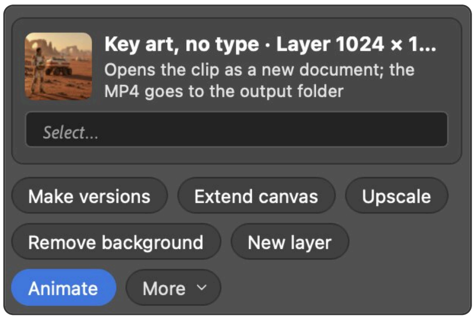
RESULT
A five-second clip, dust drifting across the plain, the type kept out of the frames.


0 S
RED HORIZON

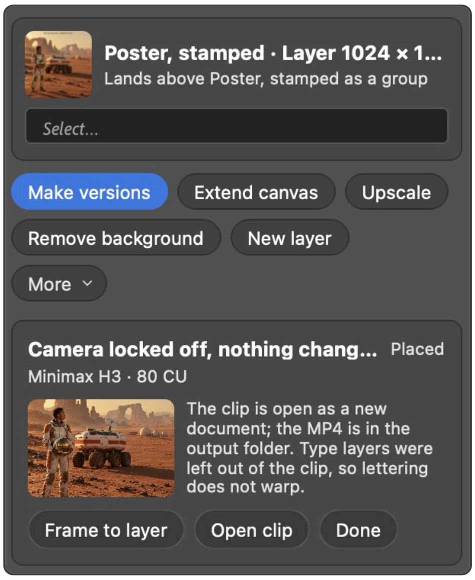

1.7 S
RED HORIZON


3.4 S
RED HORIZON


5 S
RED HORIZON


Key art, no type · Layer 1024 × 1...
Opens the clip as a new document; the MP4 goes to the output folder
Select...
Make versions
Extend canvas
Upscale
Remove background
New layer
Animate
More

RED HORIZON **Animate** on the key art: "Opens the clip as a new document; the MP4 goes to the output folder."


Poster, stamped · Layer 1024 × 1...
Lands above Poster, stamped as a group

Camera locked off, nothing chang... Placed
Minimax H3 · 80 CU
The clip is open as a new document; the MP4 is in the output folder. Type layers were left out of the clip, so lettering does not warp.
Select...
Make versions
Extend canvas
Upscale
Remove background
New layer
More
Frame to layer
Open clip
Done

RED HORIZON The result card: Minimax H3 · 80 CU, "Type layers were left out of the clip, so lettering does not warp." Frame to layer, Open clip.

"Camera locked off, nothing changes size or position. Fine red dust drifts low across the plain in the wind, the haze shimmers in the warm light, she breathes and turns her head slightly toward the horizon. The rover and the outpost stay still." Minimax H3, 5 s, 768 × 1152.

- In **More › Animate**: describe the motion; 5 s by default. The default model is Minimax H3 Fast; the clip pictured here was made with Minimax H3, picked in the Model chip.
- Animate reads the picture without its type layers, so painted motion never warps the lettering; the type stays in the document VERIFIED LIVE. Set the type again over the clip in Photoshop, or keep the clip clean for an editor.
- The clip opens as a new document with a Video Group in the Timeline; **File › Export › Render Video** writes it out. The MP4 is also saved in the output folder (chapter 15). Jobs names these jobs "Video".
- **Frame to layer** brings the clip's last frame back as a layer, to animate again from it.

11 · AGENTS

Let an agent work in Photoshop, *through the Scenario MCP.*

PHOTOSHOP
History: each change an agent makes is one named step you can undo.

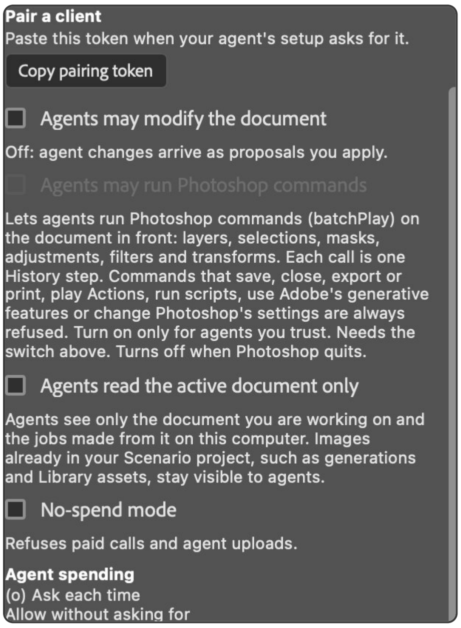
+

SCENARIO
The local Scenario MCP server, `scenario-photoshop`, for Claude Code, Codex, Cursor or Claude Desktop.

=

RESULT
An agent reads your documents, prices and runs generations and lands layers, with every spend approved in the panel.

The helper runs on your computer only, talks to the panel over `localhost` and holds no Scenario key. Every credit an agent spends goes through a card in the panel; with **Agents may modify the document** off, every result it wants to land waits on a proposal card.



Pair a client

Paste this token when your agent's setup asks for it.

☐ Agents may modify the document

Off: agent changes arrive as proposals you apply.

☐ Agents may run Photoshop commands

Lets agents run Photoshop commands (batchPlay) on the document in front: layers, selections, masks, adjustments, filters and transforms. Each call is one History step. Commands that save, close, export or print, play Actions, run scripts, use Adobe's generative features or change Photoshop's settings are always refused. Turn on only for agents you trust. Needs the switch above. Turns off when Photoshop quits.

☐ Agents read the active document only

Agents see only the document you are working on and the jobs made from it on this computer. Images already in your Scenario project, such as generations and Library assets, stay visible to agents.

☐ No-spend mode

Refuses paid calls and agent uploads.

Agent spending

(o) Ask each time

Allow without asking for

RED HORIZON Settings › **Connect an AI agent**: pairing token, the switches, No-spend mode, Agent spending.

1. Open **Settings › Connect an AI agent › Connect a client.**
2. **Copy command** for Claude Code, Codex and Cursor, run it in a terminal; **Get the extension** and **Copy token** for Claude Desktop. Buttons that hold the pairing token clear the clipboard after 60 seconds.
3. Restart the client so it starts the helper.
4. Ask "What document is open in Photoshop?". The row turns to **Connected.**

> **Development build.** The helper is not on npm yet, so the copied `npx` commands work once it is published. From a checkout, after **Copy pairing token** in the panel, run the helper with Node and `--local`:

```
pbpaste | node helper/bin/scenario-photoshop.js setup claude-code --local --token-
```

Clients and switches

Client	What the setup does	Checked
Claude Code	Saves the token in `~/.config/scenario-photoshop/token` (readable by your account only) and registers the server with `claude mcp add --scope user`. The entry holds no token.	VERIFIED LIVE
Codex	The same, with `codex mcp add scenario-photoshop`.	TESTED HEADLESS setup only
Cursor	Writes the entry into `~/.cursor/mcp.json`, keeps a backup, leaves the rest of the file as it was.	TESTED AUTOMATED
Claude Desktop	The `.mcpb` extension asks for the token and keeps it as a sensitive setting; it ships with the first published release.	NOT TESTED
Other clients	**Copy JSON** or **Copy TOML** for a user-level config. **Copy skills command** copies `npx skills add scenario-labs/skills`.	

What agents may do

Switch	Off (default)	On
Agents may modify the document	Every result an agent wants to land shows a proposal card with Apply and Dismiss	Results land at once as one History step "Scenario agent: <action>", with an Undo banner
Agents may run Photoshop commands	Refused	batchPlay on the document in front, one History step per call. Saving, closing, exporting, printing, Actions, scripts, Adobe's generative features and settings are always refused. Needs the first switch; turns off when Photoshop quits
Agents read the active document only	Agents can read every open document	Only the document you are working on, and its jobs
No-spend mode	Refuses every agent request that would spend credits, whatever the other settings say	

- **Spend card:** which client asks, what it will make with which model, the prompt, and the price on Approve. Decline spends nothing. The agent must send back the exact price it was quoted; a changed price or an expired quote is refused before anything is spent. A card left unanswered expires after 10 minutes VERIFIED LIVE.
- **Proposal card:** the client, the model, the target document and the History name; it shows no picture of the result in this build. Apply lands it in one step VERIFIED LIVE.
- **Agent spending:** **Ask each time** (default) or **Allow** for one client session, with a limit per call and a total. **End** stops it at once. The **Activity log** lists every agent request.
- **Sending pixels:** before an agent first sends pixels from a document in a session, the panel asks TESTED AUTOMATED; that card was not seen on screen live.
- Agents change only the document in front; the plugin never brings another document forward for them. Their jobs show in Jobs, marked with the client's name.

This guide has no picture of the Connect a client list or of the spend and proposal cards: neither example shot an agent run.

The 29 tools

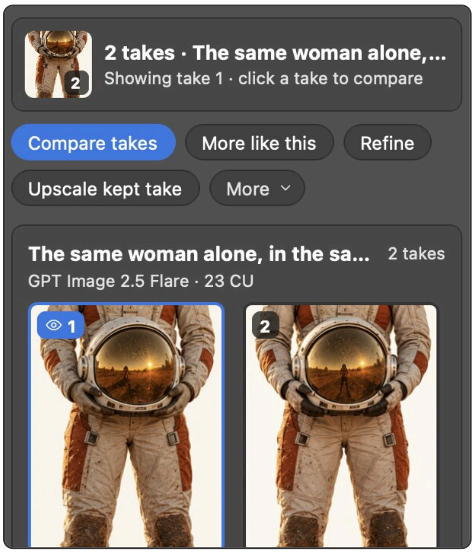
Document (read)	`scenario_status` `document_summary` `layer_detail` `preview_document`
Scenario (read, free)	`list_models` `model_schema` `recommend_models` `estimate_cost` `job_status` `wait_for_job` `list_local_jobs` `list_generations` `list_assets` `search_assets` `list_collections` `inspect_result_previews`
Inputs	`capture_reference` `upload_reference` `reference_upload_status`

Spending	`generate`
Recovery	`recover_local_job` `recover_cloud_job` `cancel_prepared_job`
Changes (first switch)	`prepare_result_application` `apply_result_application` `select_layers` `set_selection` `remove_scenario_layers`
Commands (second switch)	`execute_batchplay`

A typical edit: `document_summary`, `set_selection`, `capture_reference`, `upload_reference`, `estimate_cost`, `generate` (spend card), `wait_for_job`, `prepare_result_application`, `apply_result_application`.

12 · VERSIONS, TAKES AND MODELS

Variations to compare, *and the whole catalog one click away.*

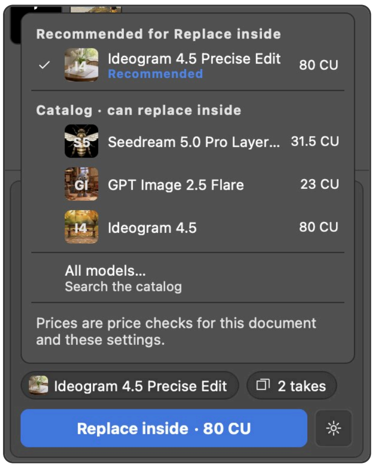

2 takes · The same woman alone,…
Showing take 1 · click a take to compare
Compare takes
More like this
Refine
Upscale kept take
More
The same woman alone, in the sa…
2 takes
GPT Image 2.5 Flare · 23 CU
1
2

RED HORIZON Make versions on the sheet: "2 takes · The same woman alone, …", "Showing take 1 · click a take to compare", Compare takes, More like this, Refine.

Make versions draws the layer again: with an empty prompt, variations of it; with a prompt, the change you describe. On Red Horizon it gave every view of the character sheet (chapter 06), two takes each, GPT Image 2.5 Flare, Make versions · 23 CU.

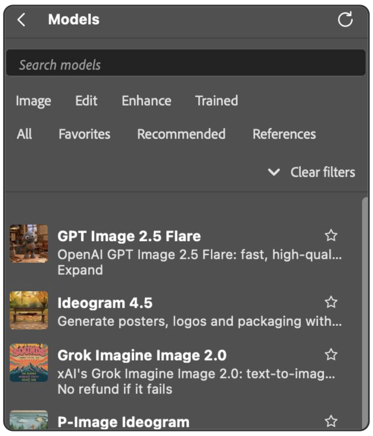
Make versions	Variations of the layer, or the change you describe ("the same woman, turned to a true side view"). Empty prompt: a built-in one is sent. Also works on a selection.
Takes chip	How many takes one run makes; the price follows.
A group of takes	Lands with take 1 visible. Select the group later, even after a restart, and the Takes card comes back from the layers' metadata VERIFIED LIVE.
Keep take	Leaves the group named after its prompt TESTED AUTOMATED. A layer you added to the group, or a copy of a take, is never deleted by Keep.

Model, Style and Edit

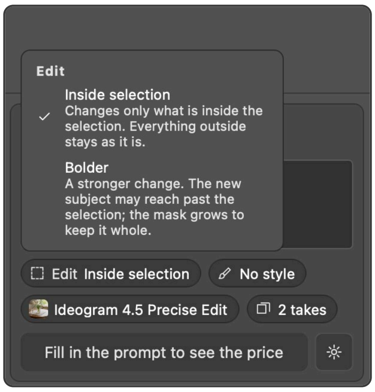

Recommended for Replace inside
Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit
Recommended
80 CU
Catalog · can replace inside
Seedream 5.0 Pro Layer…
31.5 CU
GPT Image 2.5 Flare
23 CU
Ideogram 4.5
80 CU
All models…
Search the catalog
Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit
2 takes
Replace inside · 80 CU

Prices are price checks for this document and these settings.

THE LAST KEEPER Model, on Replace inside, with each model's price for this document.


Models
Search models
Image
Edit
Enhance
Trained
All
Favorites
Recommended
References
Clear filters
GPT Image 2.5 Flare
OpenAI GPT Image 2.5 Flare: fast, high-qual…
Expand
Ideogram 4.5
Generate posters, logos and packaging with…
Grok Imagine Image 2.0
xAI's Grok Imagine Image 2.0: text-to-imag…
No refund if it fails
P-Image Ideogram

RED HORIZON All models.


Edit
Inside selection
Bolder
Edit Inside selection
No style
Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit
2 takes
Fill in the prompt to see the price

Changes only what is inside the selection. Everything outside stays as it is.

A stronger change. The new subject may reach past the selection; the mask grows to keep it whole.

RED HORIZON Edit, on Replace inside.

On The Last Keeper's boat the Model chip listed Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit at 80 CU as recommended, then Seedream 5.0 Pro Layer… at 31.5 CU, GPT Image 2.5 Flare at 23 CU and Ideogram 4.5 at 80 CU: "Prices are price checks for this document and these settings."

Model chip	The action's recommended model, then up to eight catalog models that can do it, with their prices for this document as the price checks come back, then All models… . Models that cannot take the layer are left out.
All models…	Search; the Image, Edit, Enhance and Trained tabs; All, Favorites, Recommended and References; a star keeps favorites.
Style chip	**No style** (the model's own look), **Match an image** (a picture as the style reference, with any model that takes references; NOT TESTED live) and the project's trained styles. Every composer pictured in this guide shows No style.

Trained models	Run with a trained model runs it on its base model for the action, with its trigger words before your prompt VERIFIED LIVE with FLUX.1 Dev and FLUX.2 Dev models.
+ Reference	The selection's box, the active layer, all visible, a PNG or JPEG file, or a Library image. Layers pinned as document references (Character, Set, Style, Product) stay in the document. References upload at the click.
Quality	Medium unless the gear picks High or Low.

Default models in this build, as the panel names them

Create image, New layer, Make versions, Bolder	GPT Image 2.5 Flare
Replace inside (Inside selection)	Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit
Remove	Ideogram 4.5
Select by description	SAM 3.1 Image
Cut out subject, Remove background	851 Labs Background Remover
New angle	Qwen Edit Multiangle 2511
Split into layers	Seedream 5.0 Flash Layerize

Split text, Remove text	Ideogram V3 Layerize Text
Render sketch, Relight to scene	GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst
Formats	Smart Reframe
Extend canvas	Reframe (at 2K)
Upscale	Topaz Image Upscale, ×2
Animate	Minimax H3 Fast

13 · PRICES AND JOBS

The price is on the button, *every run is a job.*

- The price is checked for free (a dry run that creates no job) about half a second after each change. The button shows it exact (Upscale ×2 · 10 CU, or Free), as a range, or as "from" a price.
- An action that needs a prompt reads **Fill in the prompt to see the price** until it has one.
- **A click on a priced button is the approval.** When the button shows more than 100 CU, the top of a range or a "from" price, a card asks first.
- The request is built again at the click. If the document, the selection or a setting changed since the price check, nothing is sent.
- If the price changes once references or captures are uploaded, the panel stops and asks again. Nothing was spent VERIFIED LIVE.
- A failed job shows "Refunded by Scenario"; a model without refunds says so before you click. The plugin shows no balance or plan: check those on app.scenario.com.

The prices the panel showed on the two examples

Action	Model and settings	Price	Example, chapter
Create image	GPT Image 2.5 Flare, quality High, 4 takes, 1024 × 1536	47 CU	Red Horizon, 04
Render sketch	GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst, 2 takes	24 CU	Red Horizon, 04
Select by description	SAM 3.1 Image	6 CU	Both, 05 and 07
Replace inside, Bolder	GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes	23 CU	Red Horizon, 05
Replace inside, Inside selection	Ideogram 4.5 Precise Edit, 2 takes	80 CU	The Last Keeper, 05
Cut out subject, Remove background	851 Labs Background Remover	1 CU	Red Horizon, 06
Make versions	GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes	23 CU	Red Horizon, 06
New layer	GPT Image 2.5 Flare, 2 takes, Lands: Cut out	27 CU	Red Horizon, 06
Split into layers	Seedream 5.0 Flash Layerize	28 CU	Red Horizon, 07
Formats	Smart Reframe, one format	45 CU	Red Horizon, 08
Upscale ×2	Topaz Image Upscale	10 CU	Red Horizon, 09
Animate	Minimax H3, 5 s	80 CU	Red Horizon, 10

Each price is the one the panel showed for that document and those settings. Another size, model, quality or number of takes gives another price: read the button.

Jobs

Every run, yours or an agent's, is a job on this computer. **Jobs** in the header lists the newest, each with its time and price, then **All jobs**: each job with its picture, status, the price quoted and the price charged, and its actions. Each job keeps what was asked (model, prompt, settings) and where its result went. Jobs is also where a result that did not land is placed by hand.

Written first	Each job is written to disk before anything is sent, so Jobs survives a restart VERIFIED LIVE on 0.5.0.
After a restart	Uploading or waiting jobs become not sent (nothing charged); generating jobs resume; finished ones download again; nothing lands by itself.

Unknown	A request that may or may not have reached Scenario. The plugin looks it up: `Link` continues a match; `Mark not sent` appears only when a full look-up found none. Nothing is paid twice TESTED AUTOMATED.
Place	`Place` , `Place in current document` and `Open as document` land a finished result where you choose.

14 · LIBRARY AND SETTINGS

Your project's images, *one click from the document.*

- **Place from Library**: More › Layers, or the chip on a blank canvas. A grid of the project's images with search and the filters All, Generated, Edited, Uploaded, then `Show more` .
- Click an image to place it as a new layer at its own size, never enlarged, centered, in one History state VERIFIED LIVE.
- `+ Reference › Library` uses the same grid.
- Everything the panel makes is also in your Scenario project, so the takes you did not keep are here too.
- Search matches asset names, which are often not the words of the prompt. Thumbnails of recent assets can stay gray for a while. Dragging from the grid is not in this build.

Settings

From the panel menu. **Account**: the signed-in project, `Add a key for another project` , `Test connection` , `Sign out` (chapter 02). **Connect an AI agent**: the link status, the pairing token, the three agent switches, No-spend mode, Agent spending, `Connect a client` and the Activity log (chapter 11). **Diagnostics**: `Copy diagnostics` shows its text before copying it.

15 · PRIVACY AND FILES

What leaves your computer, *and when.*

Sent to Scenario's API

Your key and secret with every request, over HTTPS. Prompt, model and settings for price checks and runs. Pixels only at your click: the selection's box plus a margin, a layer or the document, the mask, and your references, each upload under 4,000,000 bytes.

Downloaded

Results from Scenario's CDN (`cdn.cloud.scenario.com`, the only download host this build accepts) through signed links kept in memory, without your key.

To an agent

What a connected agent reads, including previews of your documents, goes to that agent's model provider, under your agreement with that provider. The helper never receives your key.

Where things are kept

Results	Saved before they are placed, kept or not, in the plugin's output folder: `~/Library/Application Support/Adobe/UXP/PluginsStorage/PHSP/27/External/com.scenario.photoshop/PluginData/Scenario/<kind>/<date>/`. Also in your Scenario project.
Layer metadata	Each placed layer carries model, prompt, settings, job and prices in its XMP, which survives saving the PSD. Never your key, secret, token, team or project ids, or file paths.
Job records	In the plugin data folder: prompt, settings, model, ids, prices quoted and charged, the target document's title.
Key and token	Photoshop's secure storage. The helper's token file is readable by your account only.
Diagnostics	Versions, switch states, job counts and recent error types, with no prompts, names, ids, paths, keys or tokens.

The local link

- Listens on port 9890 of the loopback interface only, which other computers cannot reach. Web pages are refused.
- The plugin and each helper prove they hold the pairing token without sending it.
- Programs that already run under your account can read the token file: a limit on your key caps spending either way.

Deleting your data

- On this computer: sign out, reset the pairing token, delete the plugin data folder.
- On Scenario: delete uploads and results in the web app; anything else, write to support@scenario.com.
- Keys: delete them on app.scenario.com. Signing out does not revoke a key.
- Security reports: privately to support@scenario.com with "security" in the subject.

16 · TROUBLESHOOTING

When something does not *behave as expected.*

What you see	What to do
The panel is empty on Photoshop's Home screen	Make or open a document. Photoshop hides docked panels on Home.
"Scenario did not accept this key and secret."	Check you copied both, from a Project key. Enter key again or Create an API key .
"API keys need a Starter plan or above."	Use a team on a plan with API access, or Open plans . Copy a request for your admin prepares the message.
A Team (Organization) key or a Reader key	Use a Project key with the Editor role.
Fill in the prompt to see the price	The action needs a prompt.
A card says the price changed	Nothing was spent. Approve at the new price or Cancel .
A job is Unknown	Open Jobs and let it look the job up; Link or Mark not sent .
A result did not land	Bring the document it started from to the front, then Place in Jobs, or Open as document .
"No connection to Scenario."	Check the network, then Retry . A job being sent when the connection dropped shows as Unknown until it is looked up.
"Photoshop is busy. Try again in a moment."	Photoshop was placing or reading; the panel tried three times. Click again.
A Request For Permission card from Photoshop	The first link the panel opens to a new site asks Photoshop's permission; answer it.
Upscale stops with a new size and price	The source is over the 4 MB upload limit. Click again to run at the size shown (chapter 09).
A subject cut at the edge of a format	Name it in the Formats prompt ("keep the explorer and the rover whole in frame") and run that format again.
A split element without its shadow, or off its place	Bring the shadow back from the original with a layer mask, and move the element back with Move (chapter 07).

Agents

`NotConnected`	Open the Scenario panel; the helper reaches it only while it is open.
`PairingFailed`	The token changed (after Reset). Run the setup command again from Connect a client.
`VersionMismatch`	The plugin and the helper versions differ. Connect a client shows the command for the new version.
`SwitchOff` , or a proposal card	Turn on Agents may modify the document, or use Apply on the card.
`DocumentNotActive`	Bring the document forward, then ask the agent to retry.
`NoSpend`	Turn off No-spend mode in Settings.
`QuoteExpired` , `CostMismatch`	Nothing was spent. The agent prices the run again.
`SpendDeclined` , `UploadDeclined`	You declined the card. Nothing was spent or sent.
`npx` not found	Install Node.js 20 or later, or use Claude Desktop's extension.

17 · KNOWN LIMITS

What this build does not do yet, *and what was not tested.*

Not in this build

- Start a set, Same action on each, and Run a workflow.
- Drag and drop onto the panel or from the Library grid.
- The update check, an Output Folder setting, and settings to leave prompts or prices out of the layer metadata.
- Uploads over 4 MB: captures are reduced; a reference file still over the limit is refused.
- The Adobe Marketplace listing and the helper on npm.
- The agent's plan card is built, but the agent link does not send plans yet.

Results to look at closely

- Extend canvas can show a step or a repeated detail at the old edge (chapter 08).
- Inside selection can leave a lighter or darker patch at the selection edge.
- The edge checks do not catch every visible patch: treat Edges ok as a hint.
- Split into layers can misplace an element without a note, and can leave cast shadows out of every element; layers are named Element 1, 2, ... in the model's order (chapter 07).
- New layer's cut out relies on Photoshop's Remove Background when the model ignores the transparent background; with several elements it can keep the wrong one, and a soft halo can stay (chapter 06).
- Relight can redraw details: name what must stay.
- Text painted into the pixels is reframed by Formats with the picture and can be cut.
- A reference of the same scene can be copied into the selection on Replace inside.

Not tested

- Windows, and Photoshop versions other than 27.11.
- Installing the release `.ccx`, by command or by double-click, and the time from install to a first image.
- Typing into the sign-in fields, and the refused-key and no-API-access screens live.
- Color-managed documents (other than sRGB), 16-bit, CMYK, Lab, documents over about 8000 px, and Undo and Redo of a landed result.
- Match an image live; the trained Z-Image route and a stacked style.
- Cursor and Claude Desktop sessions; a Codex session against Photoshop; two agent clients at once.
- Losing the connection during a run (its recovery is tested automated).
- Panel widths other than 320 px on 0.7.x.
- The panel following a Free Transform or a Move before New angle (tested automated only).

Interface

- After New angle the Takes card is titled "Edit".
- Some context lines still name raw layers.
- Opening a clip or a Formats document can rearrange other docked panels.
- After a Photoshop relaunch the panel shows hover states only after a first click in it.
- An agent's `wait_for_job` returns after its timeout (45 s by default) with no progress in between.

The full list, with how each item was checked: `docs/KNOWN_LIMITATIONS.md` in the repository.

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Links

Code, issues and full docs
github.com/scenario-labs/photoshop-plugin

Create an API key
app.scenario.com, your project's API keys

Scenario skills for agents
npx skills add scenario-labs/skills

Scenario documentation
docs.scenario.com

Trust portal
trust.scenario.com

Support and security reports
support@scenario.com

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